

# CME 250: Introduction to Machine Learning

## Lecture 7: Unsupervised Learning



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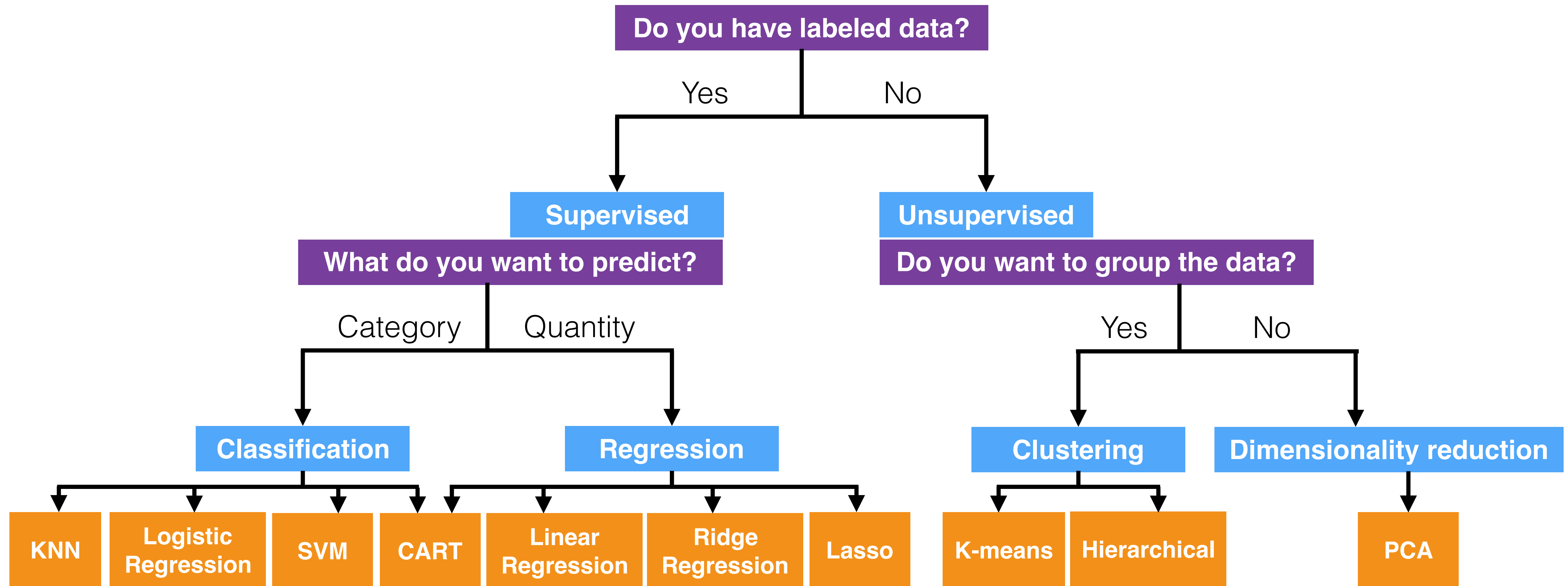


# Agenda

Slides are online at  
[cme250.stanford.edu](https://cme250.stanford.edu)

- Clustering methods
  - K-means clustering
  - Hierarchical clustering
- Dimensionality reduction
  - PCA

# Machine Learning Methods





# Unsupervised Learning

Recall: A set of statistical tools for data that only has features/input available, but no response.

In other words, we have  $X$ 's but no labels  $y$ .

Goal: Discover interesting patterns/properties of the data.

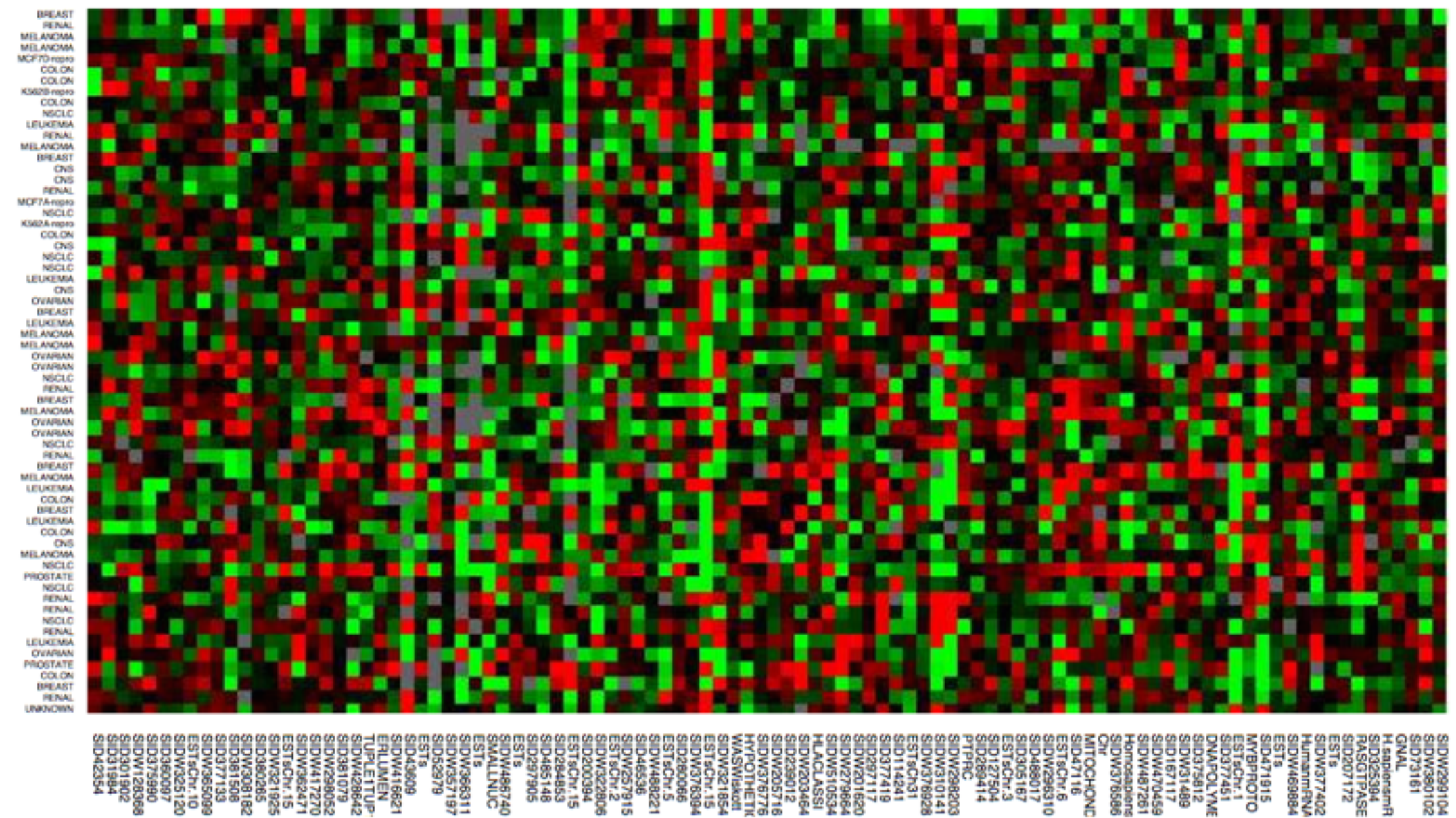
- E.g. for visualizing or interpreting high-dimensional data.



# Unsupervised Learning

Example applications:

- Given tissue samples from  $n$  patients with breast cancer, identify unknown subtypes of breast cancer.
- Gene expression experiments have thousands of variables. Represent the data using a smaller set of features for visualization and interpretation.

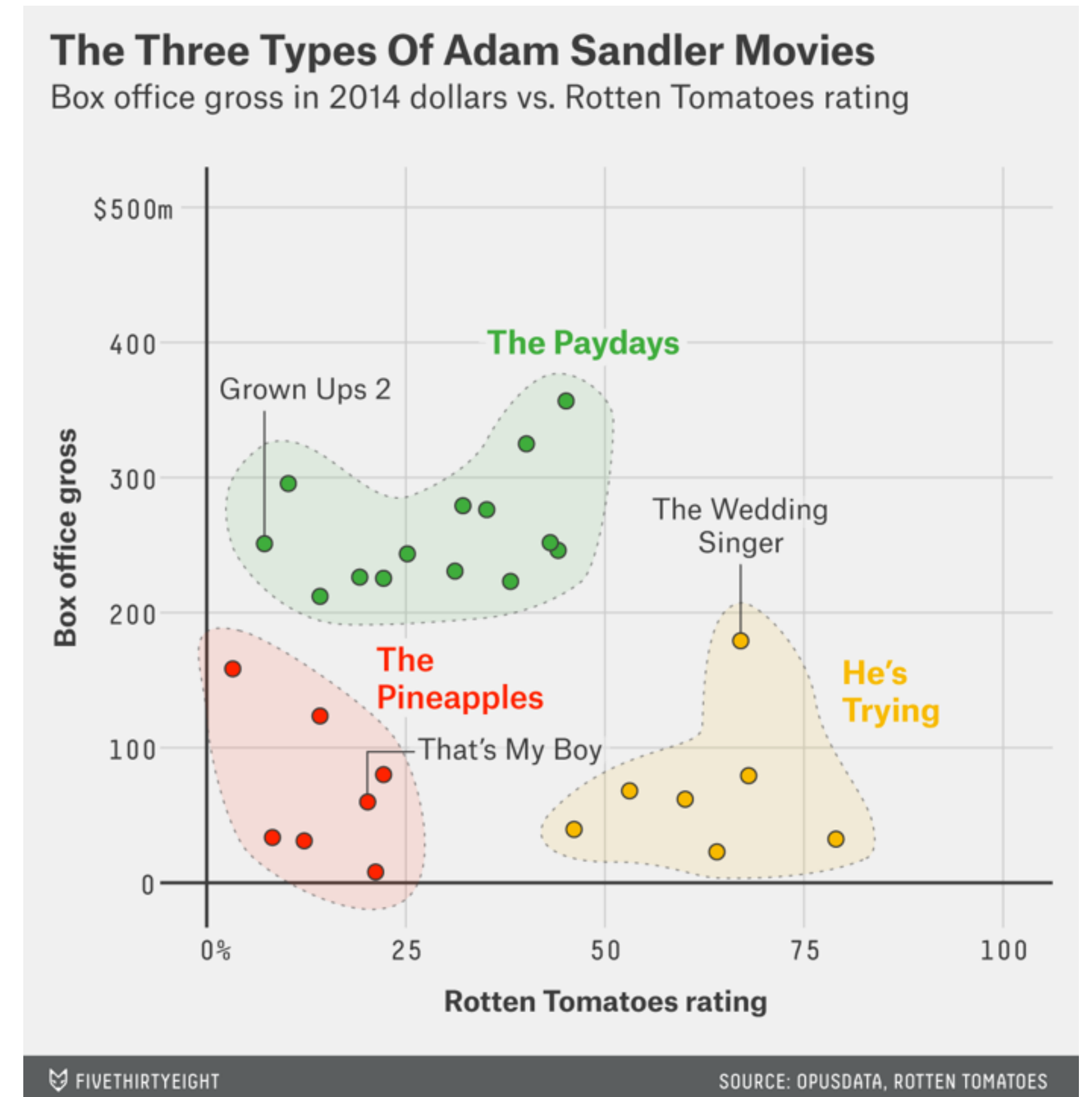




# Unsupervised Learning

Example applications:

- Document clustering: identify sets of documents about the same topic.
- Given high-dimensional facial images, find a compact representation as inputs for a facial recognition classifier.



# Challenges of Unsupervised Learning

Why is unsupervised learning challenging?

- Exploratory data analysis — goal is not always clearly defined
- Difficult to assess performance — “right answer” unknown
- Working with high-dimensional data

# Types of Unsupervised Learning

Two approaches:

- **Cluster analysis**
  - For identifying homogenous subgroups of samples
- **Dimensionality reduction**
  - For finding a low-dimensional representation to characterize and visualize the data



# Cluster Analysis

# Clustering

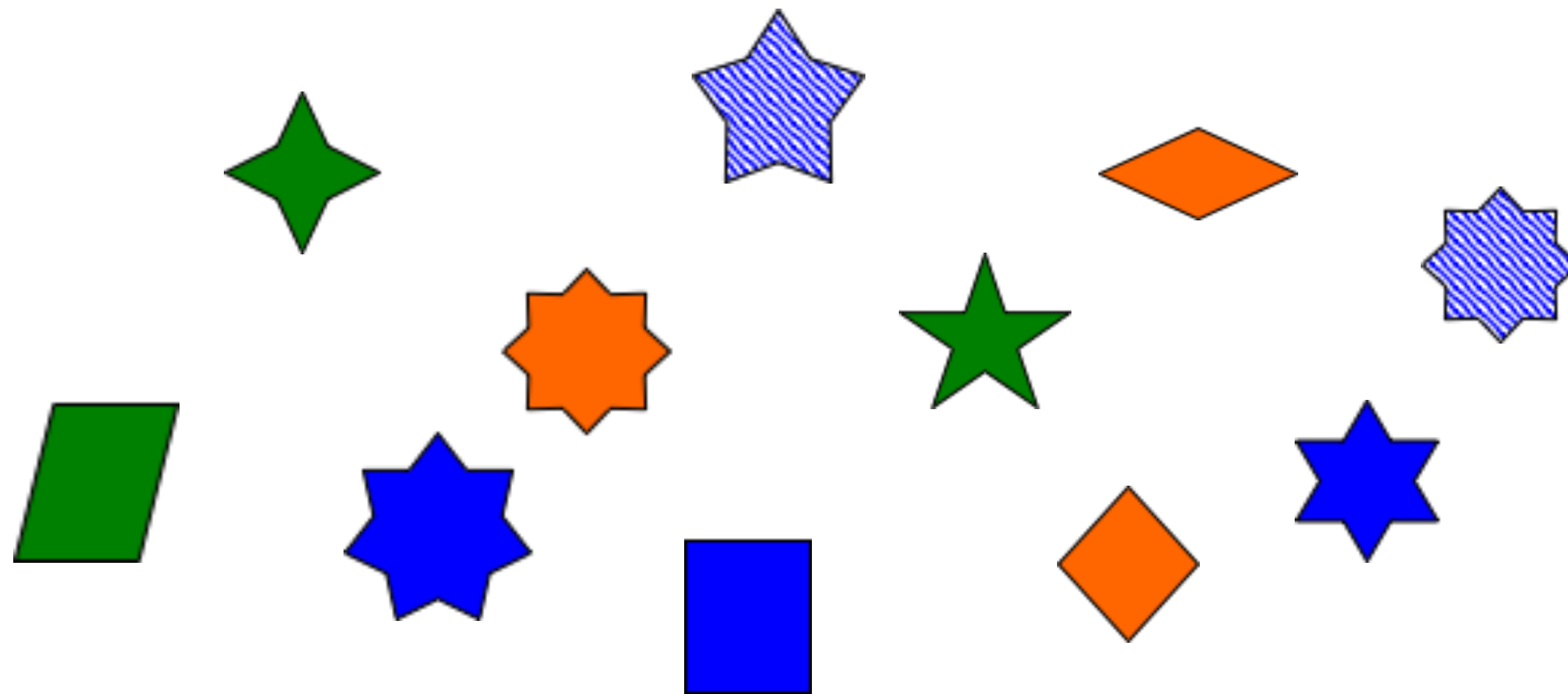
A set of methods for finding subgroups within the dataset.

- Observations should share common characteristics within the same group, but differ across groups.
- Groupings are determined from attributes of the data itself — differs from classification.



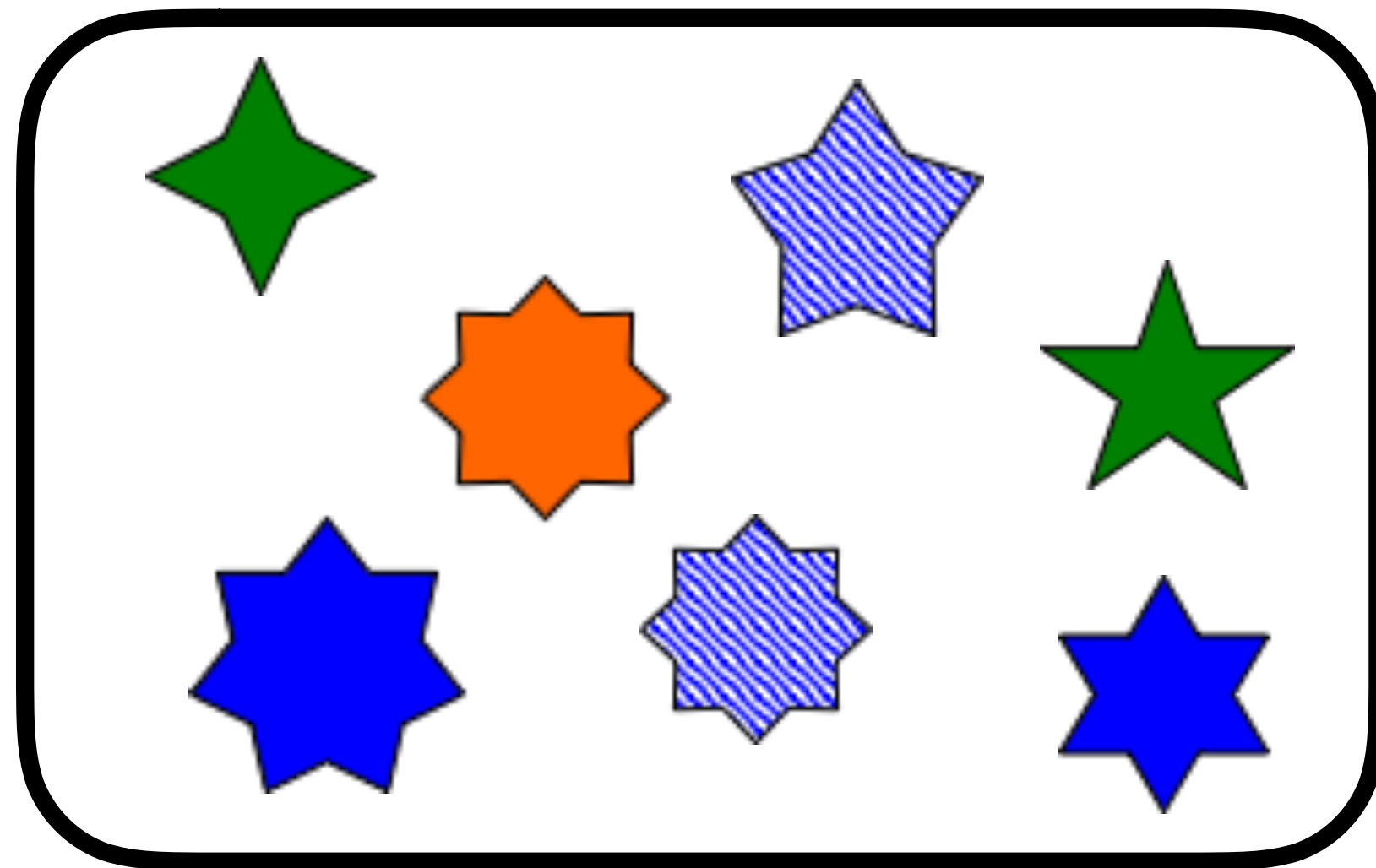
<https://medium.com/square-corner-blog/so-you-have-some-clusters-now-what-abfd297a575b>

# Clustering vs. Classification

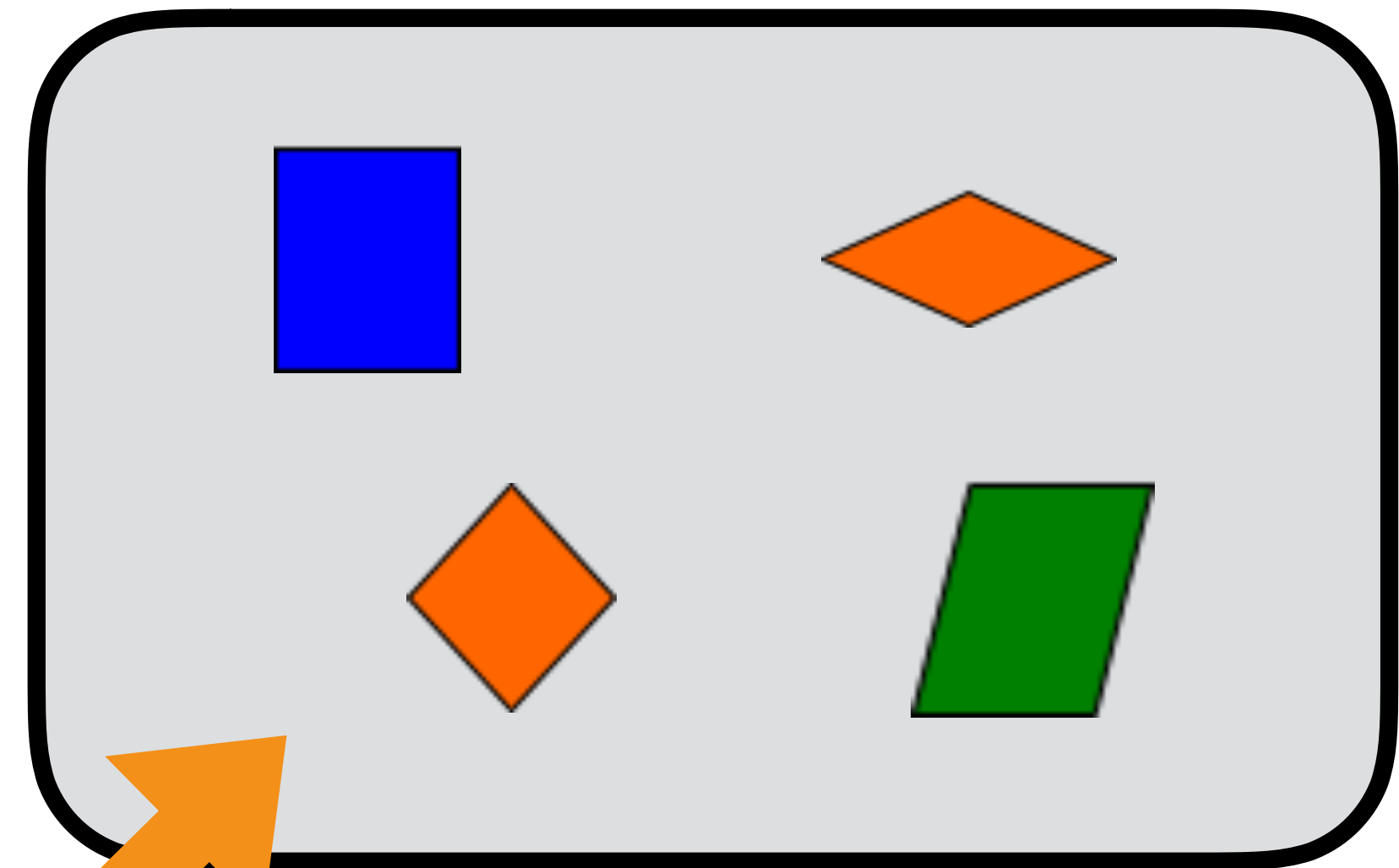




# Classification



Class A

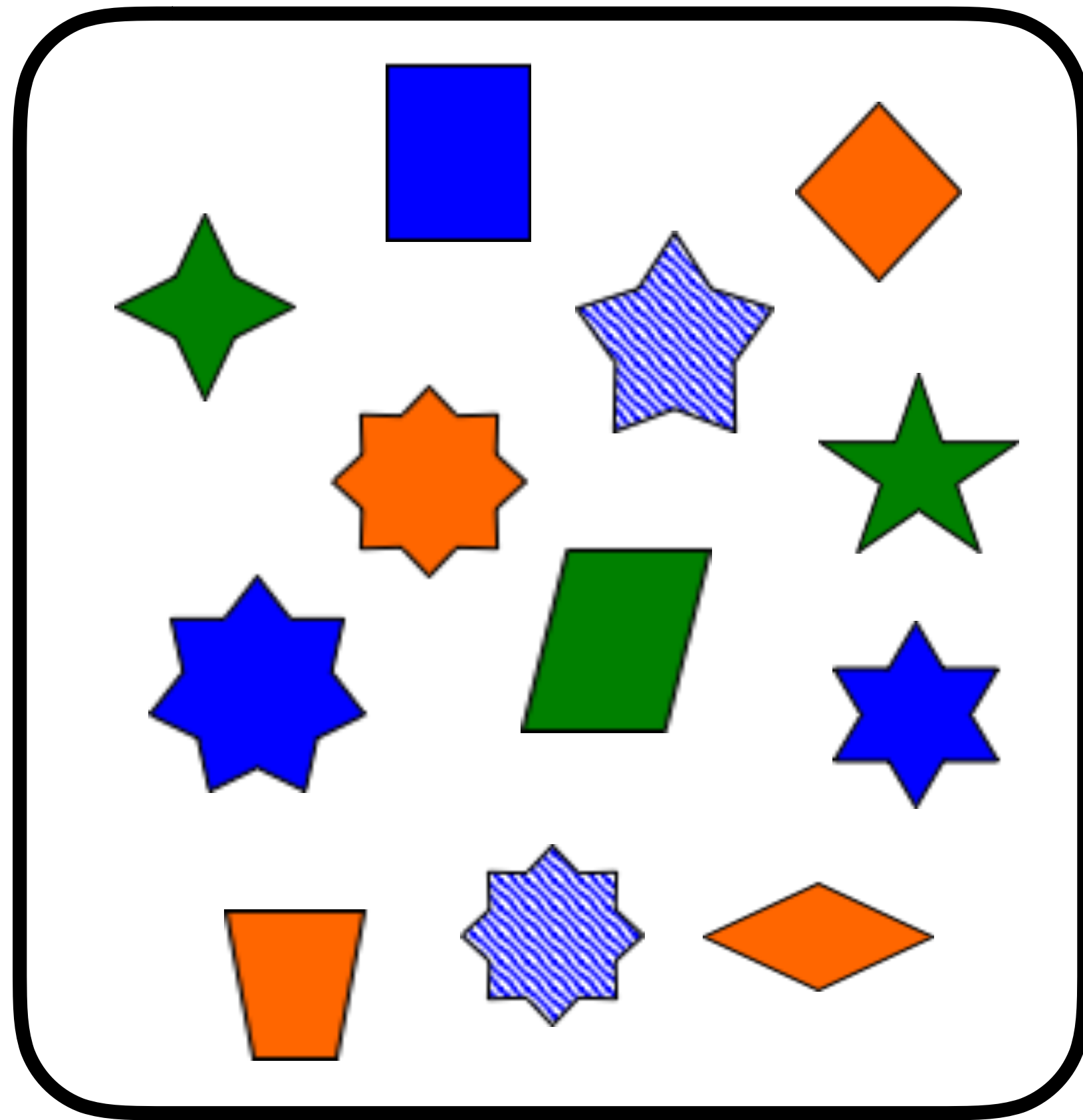


Class B



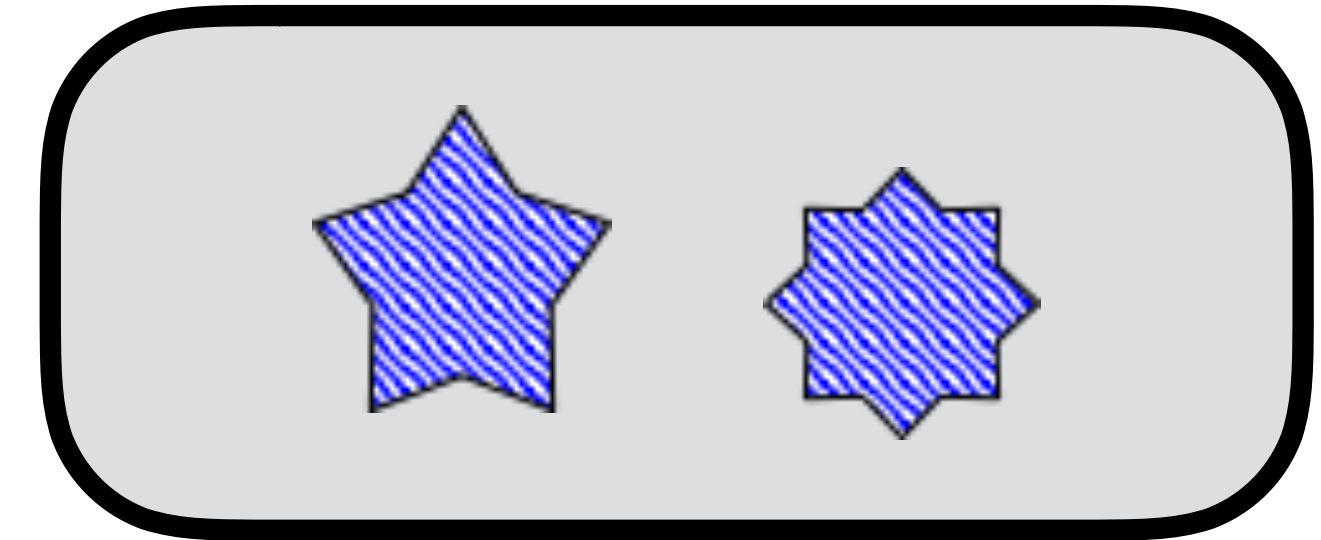


# Clustering

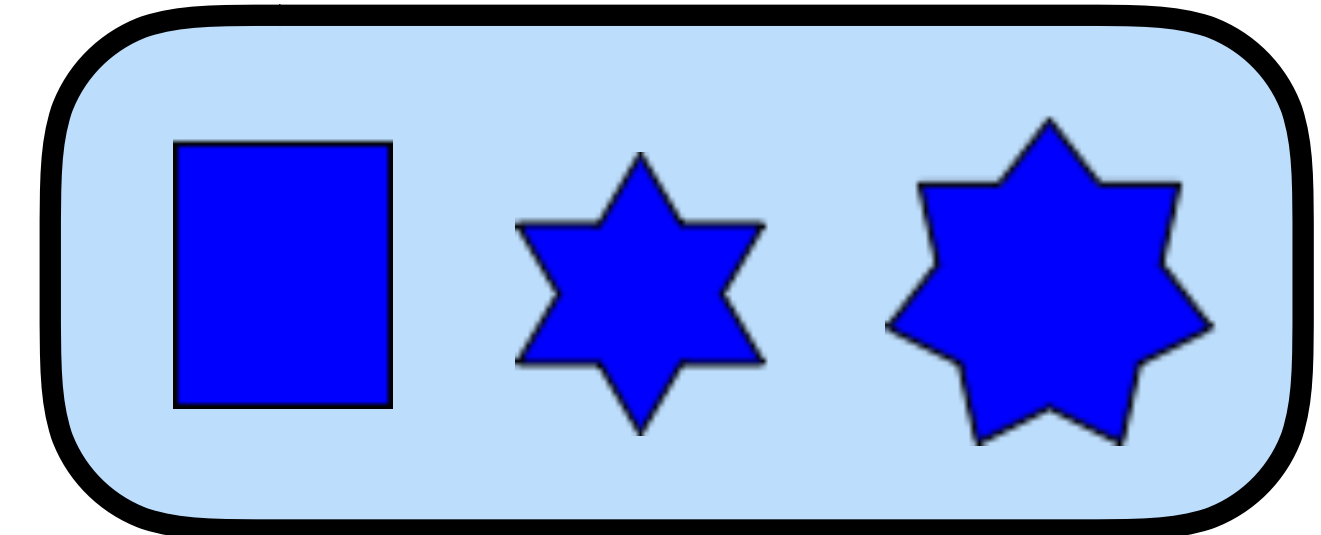


Dataset

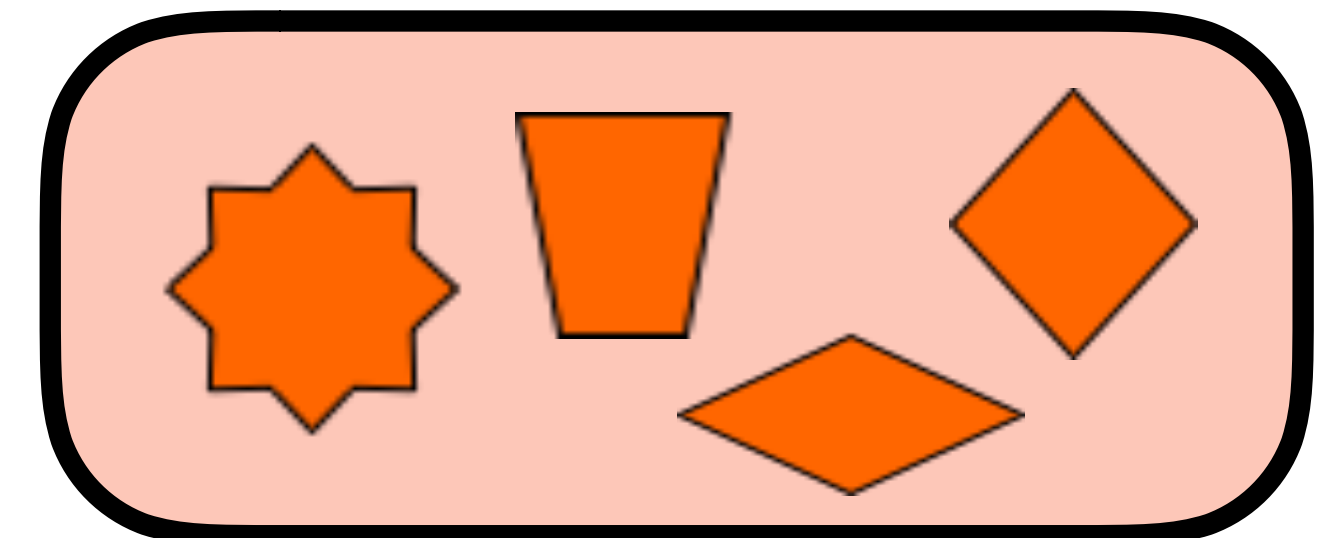
Cluster A



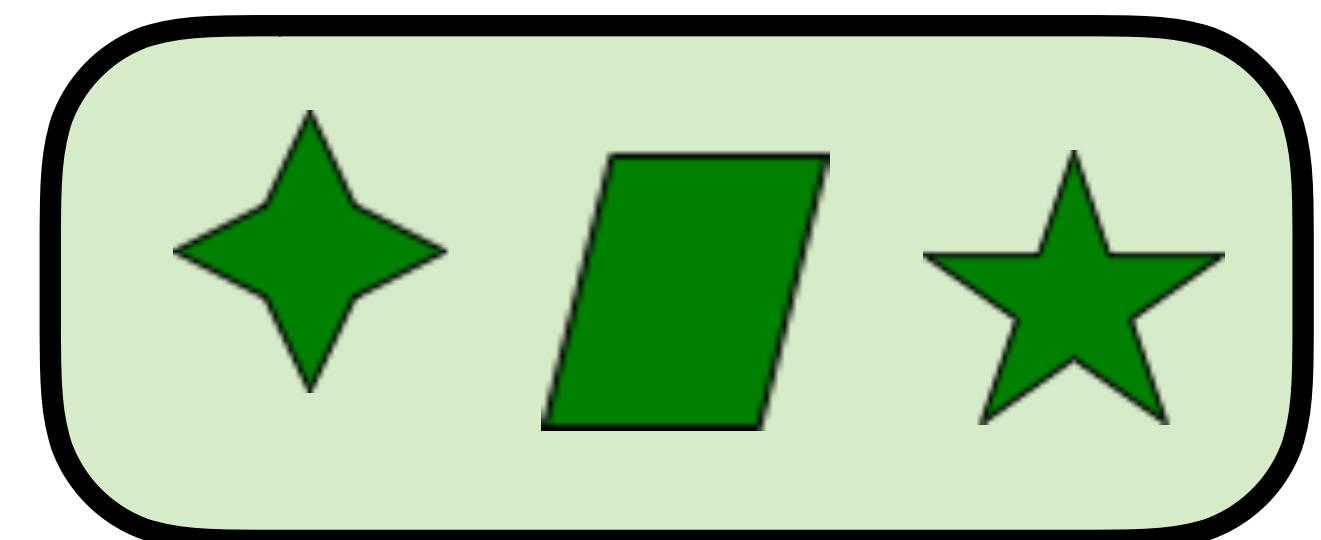
Cluster B



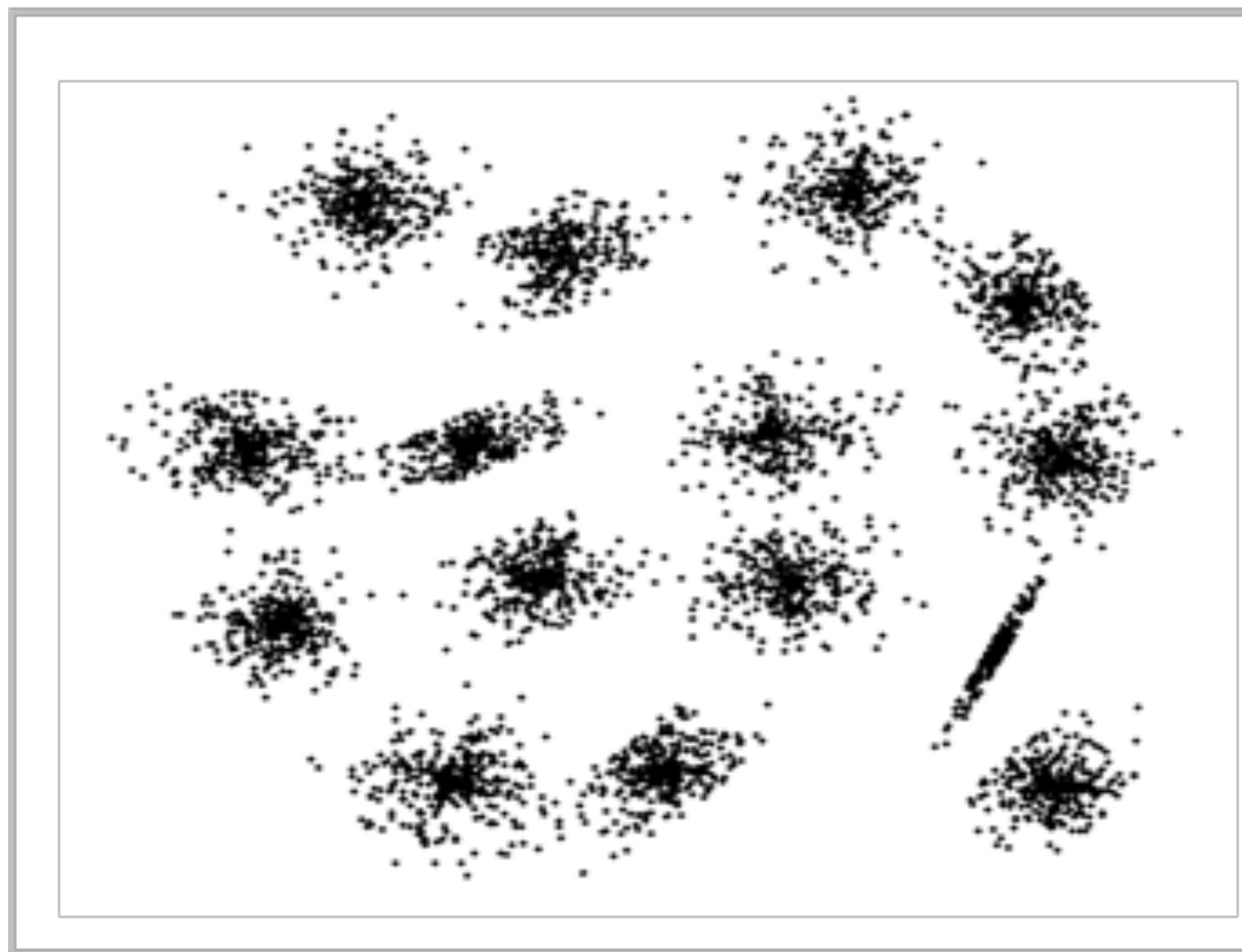
Cluster C



Cluster D



# Clustering



<http://cs.joensuu.fi/sipu/datasets/>

# Types of Clustering

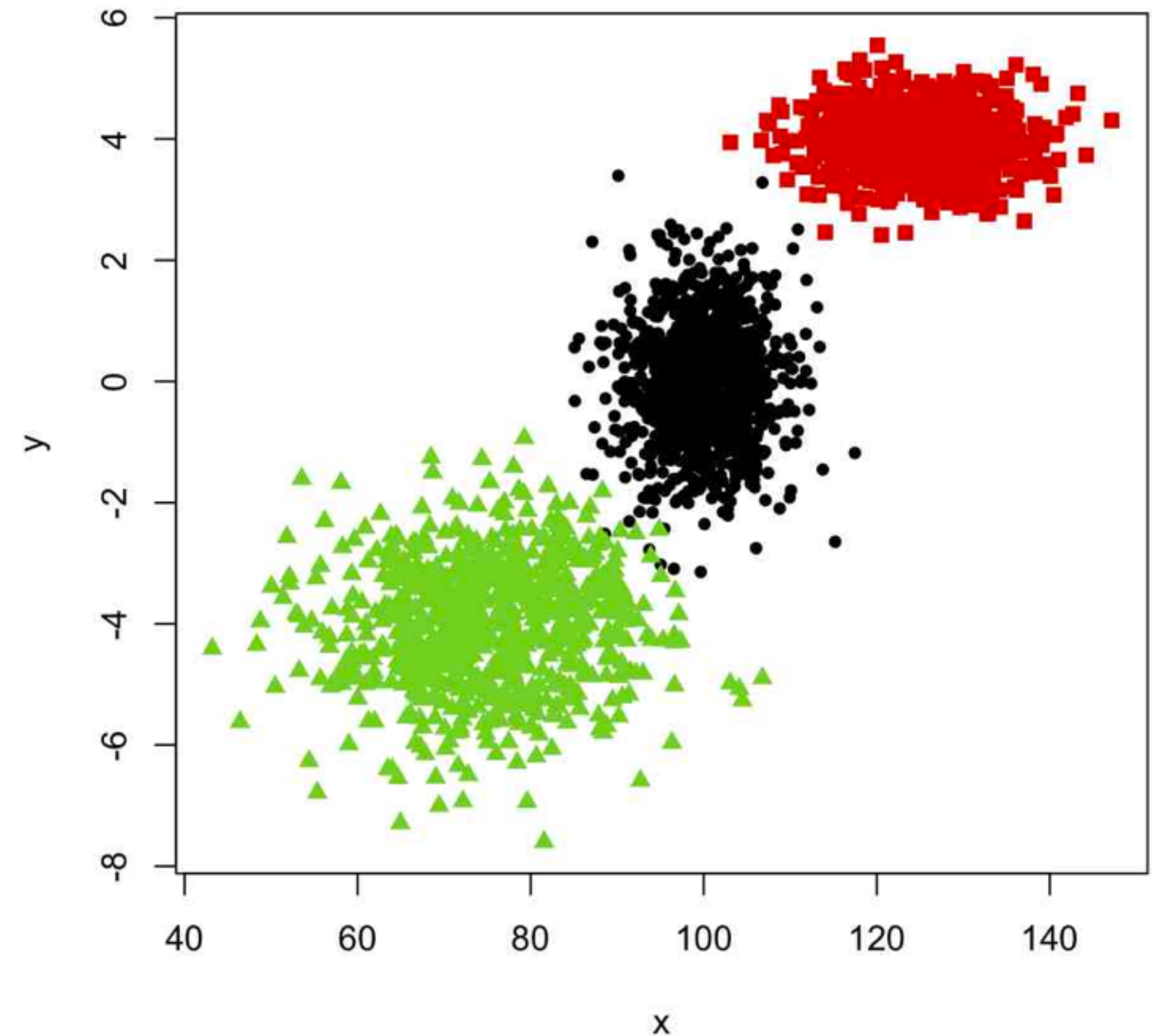
- **Centroid-based clustering**
- **Hierarchical clustering**
- **Model-based clustering**
  - Each cluster is represented by a parametric distribution
  - Dataset is a mixture of distributions
- **Hard vs. soft/fuzzy clustering**
  - Hard: observations divided into distinct clusters
  - Soft: observations may belong to more than one cluster



# K-means Clustering

Groups data into  $K$  clusters that satisfy two properties.

1. Each observation belongs to at least one of the  $K$  clusters.
2. Clusters are non-overlapping.  
No observation belongs to more than one cluster.





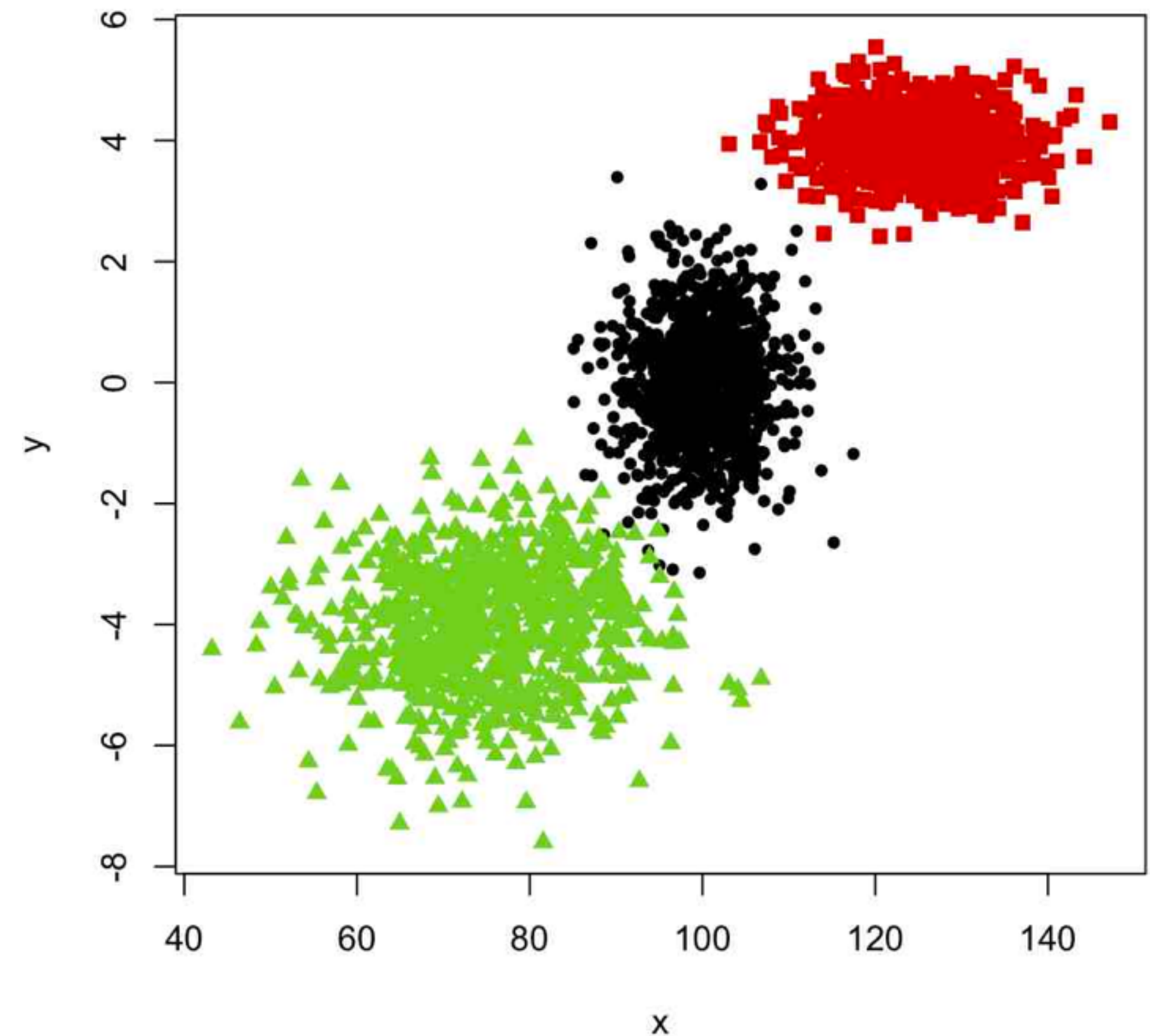
# K-means Clustering

A good clustering is one for which the *within-cluster variation* is as small as possible.

Denote each cluster by  $C_k$ , and let  $W(C_k)$  be a measure of the within-cluster variation.

K-means aims to solve

$$\underset{C_1, \dots, C_K}{\text{minimize}} \left\{ \sum_{k=1}^K W(C_k) \right\}$$





# K-means Clustering

How to measure within-cluster variation?

The most common choice is squared Euclidean distance.

$$W(C_k) = \frac{1}{|C_k|} \sum_{i, i' \in C_k} \sum_{j=1}^p (x_{ij} - x_{i'j})^2$$

Which means overall we solve

$$\text{minimize}_{C_1, \dots, C_K} \left\{ \sum_{k=1}^K \frac{1}{|C_k|} \sum_{i, i' \in C_k} \sum_{j=1}^p (x_{ij} - x_{i'j})^2 \right\}$$

# K-means Clustering

It turns out that this optimization problem is difficult to solve, as it is discrete and there are nearly  $K^n$  ways to split  $n$  samples into  $K$  clusters.

In practice, use an iterative algorithm that finds a local minimum to this optimization.

# K-means Clustering Algorithm

1. Initialize each observation to a cluster by randomly assigning a cluster, from 1 to  $K$ , to each observation.
2. Iterate until the cluster assignments stop changing:
  - a. For each of the  $K$  clusters, compute the cluster centroid. The  $k$ -th cluster centroid is the vector of the  $p$  feature means for the observations in the  $k$ -th cluster.
  - b. Assign each observation to the cluster whose centroid is closest (using Euclidean distance as the metric).



# K-means Clustering Iterations

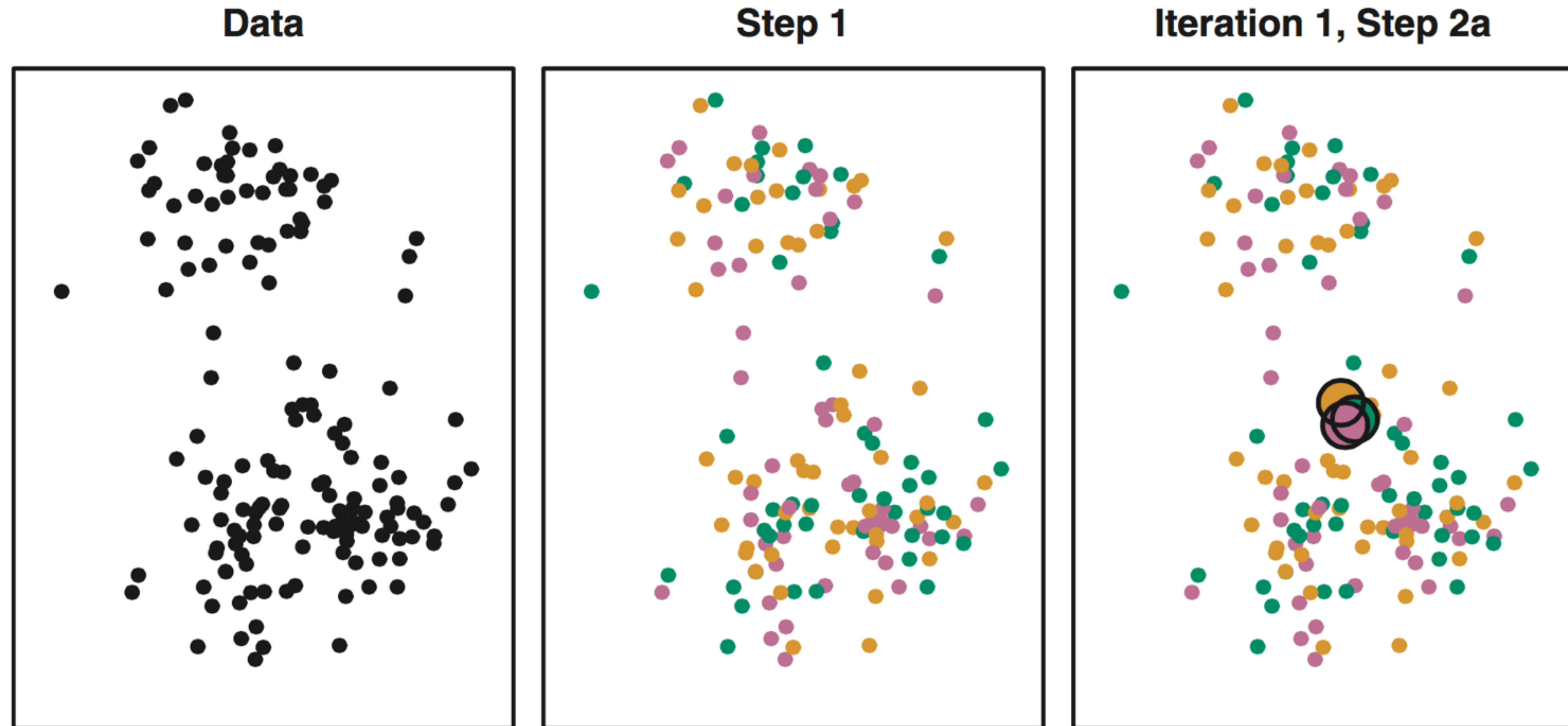


FIGURE 10.6, ISL (8th printing 2017)

# K-means Clustering Iterations

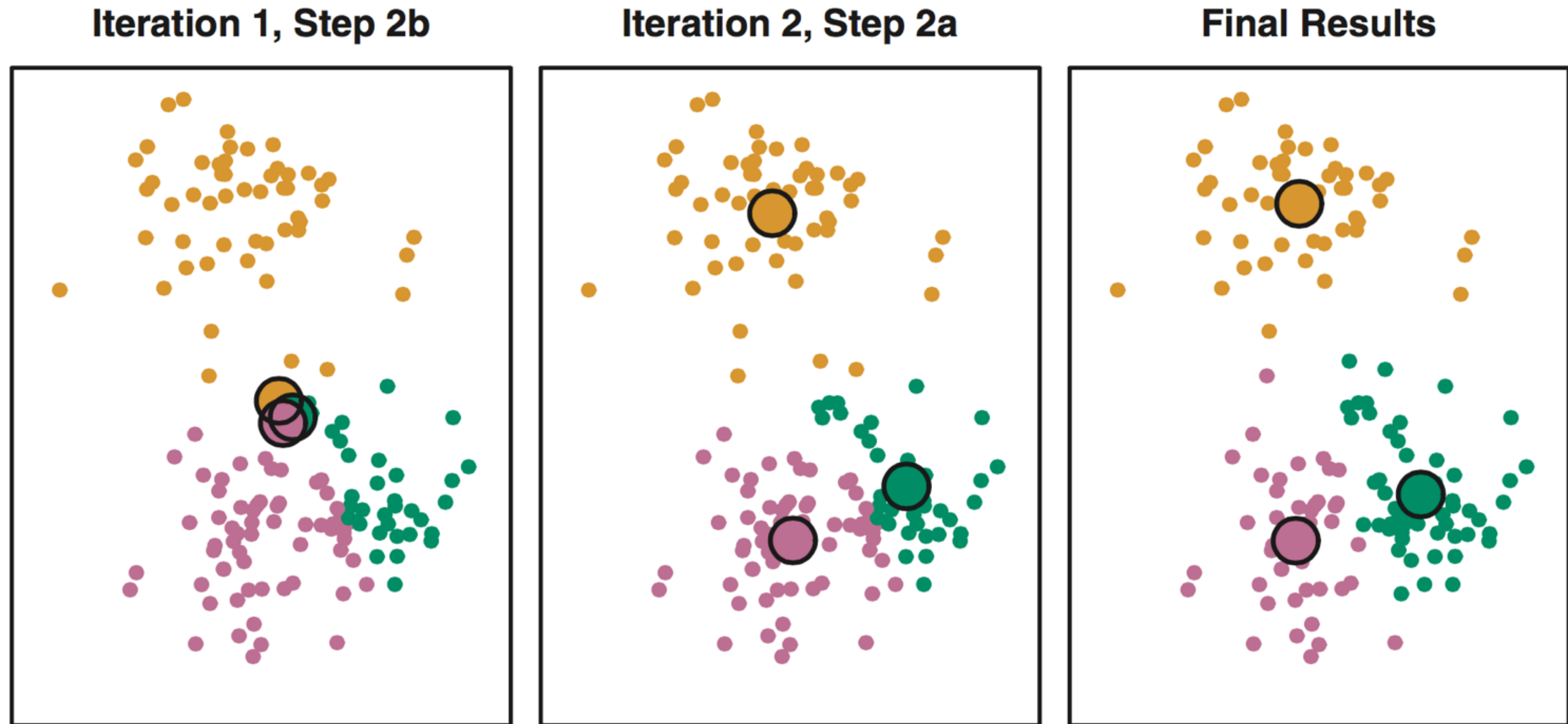
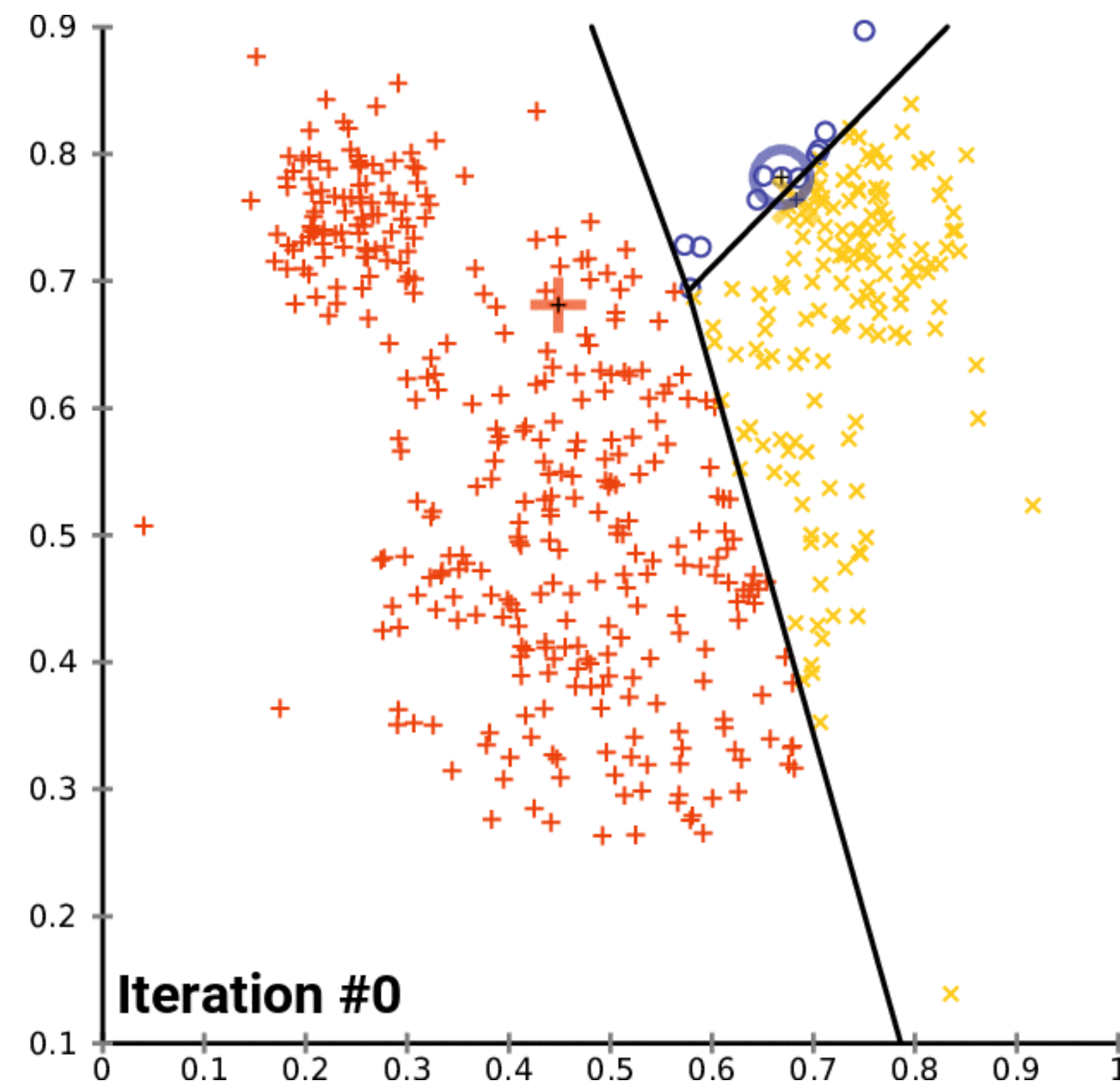


FIGURE 10.6, ISL (8th printing 2017)



# K-means Clustering Animation



# K-means Clustering Properties

It can be shown that the value of the objective function will never increase at each iteration of k-means.

Since the algorithm finds local minima, however, it will result in different clusters with different initializations.



FIGURE 10.7, ISL (8th printing 2017)

# K-means Pros and Cons

## **Pros:**

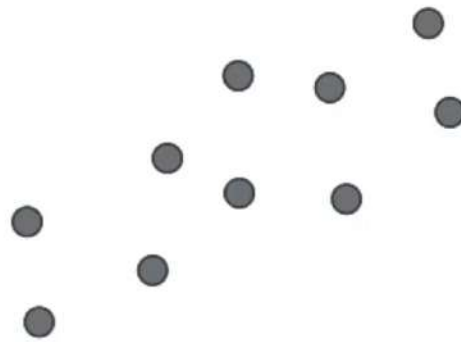
- Easy to implement and understand

## **Cons:**

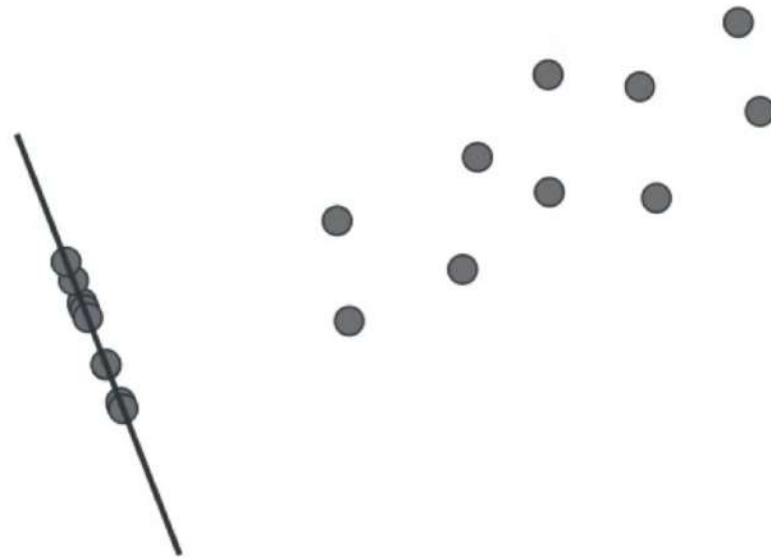
- Not robust to data perturbations and different initializations
- Treats each feature equally, not robust to noise features or different scales of features — looks for in spherical clusters in feature space
- Need to define  $K$  before running algorithm



# Dimensionality Reduction

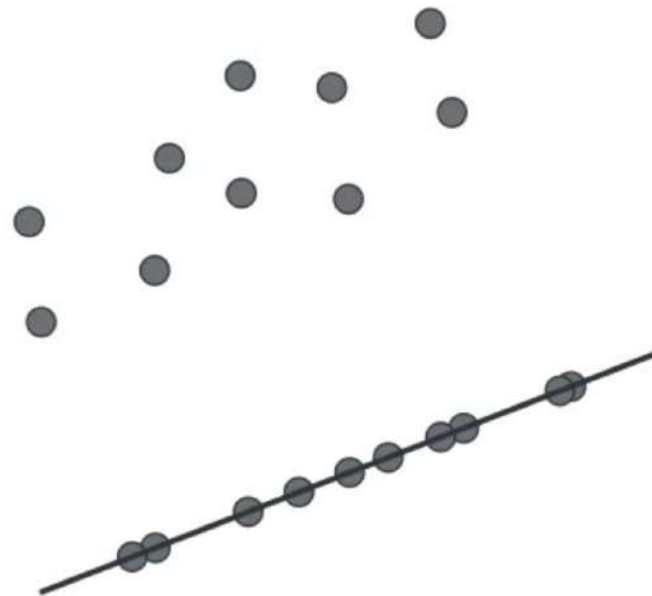


# Dimensionality Reduction

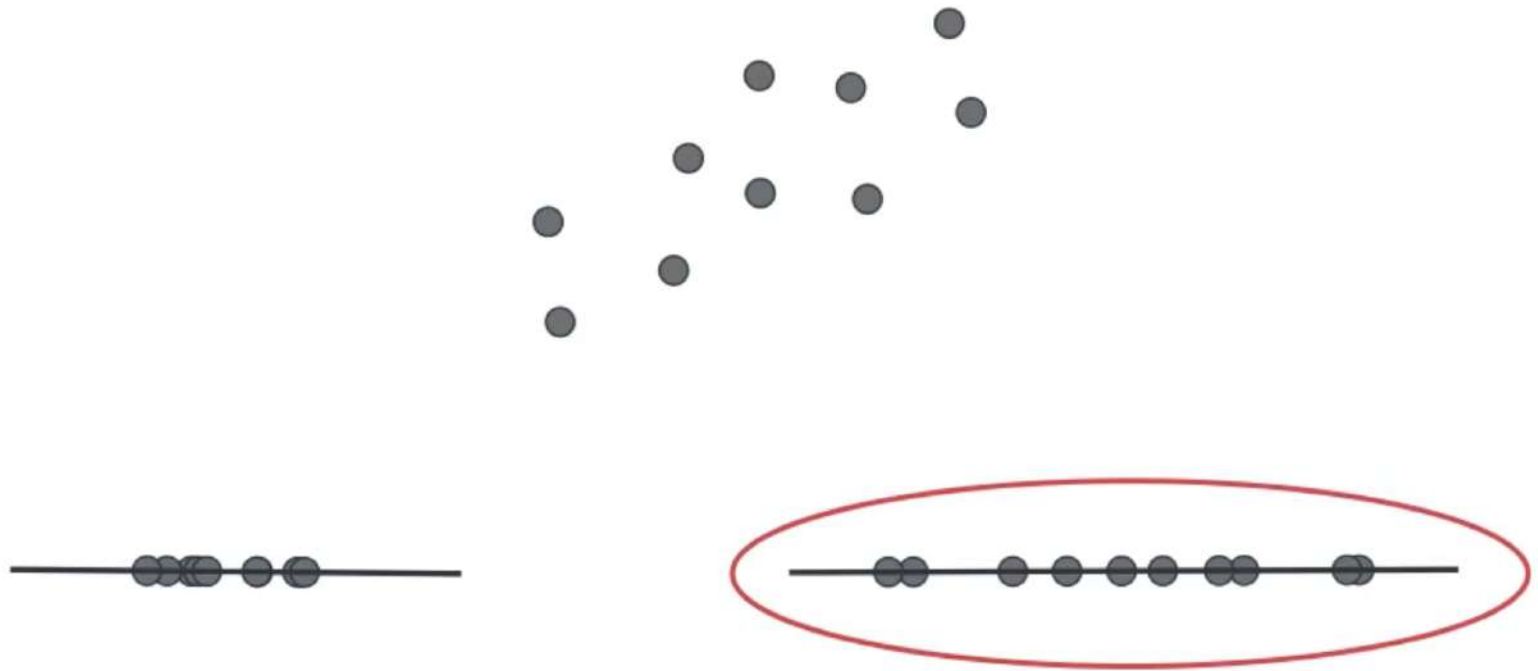




# Dimensionality Reduction



# Dimensionality Reduction



# Housing Data

Size

Number of rooms

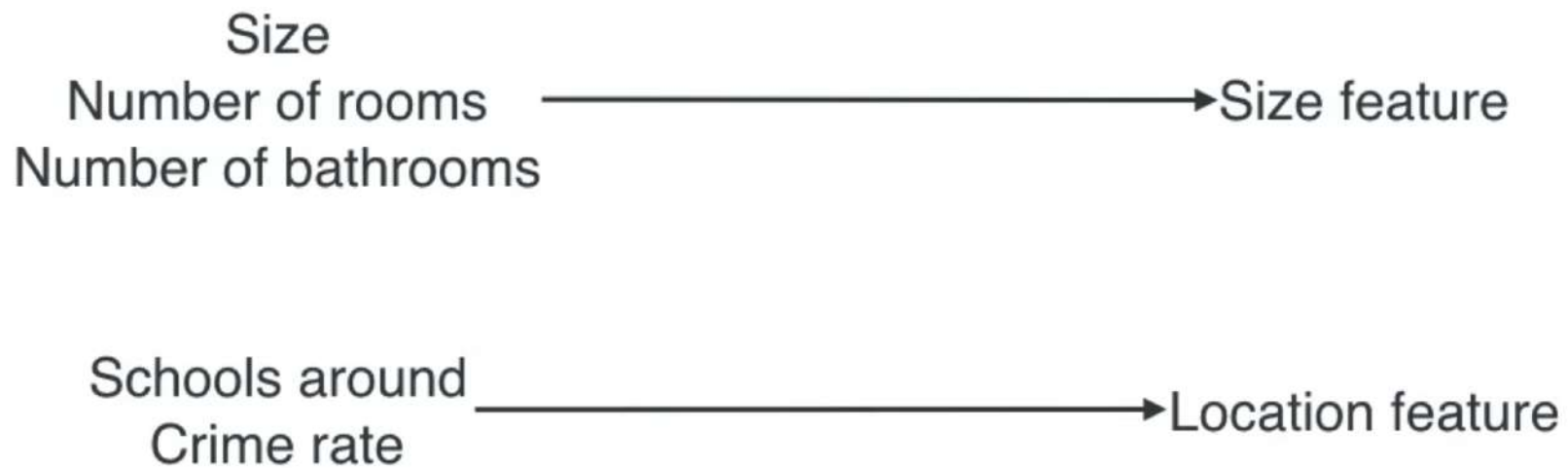
Number of bathrooms

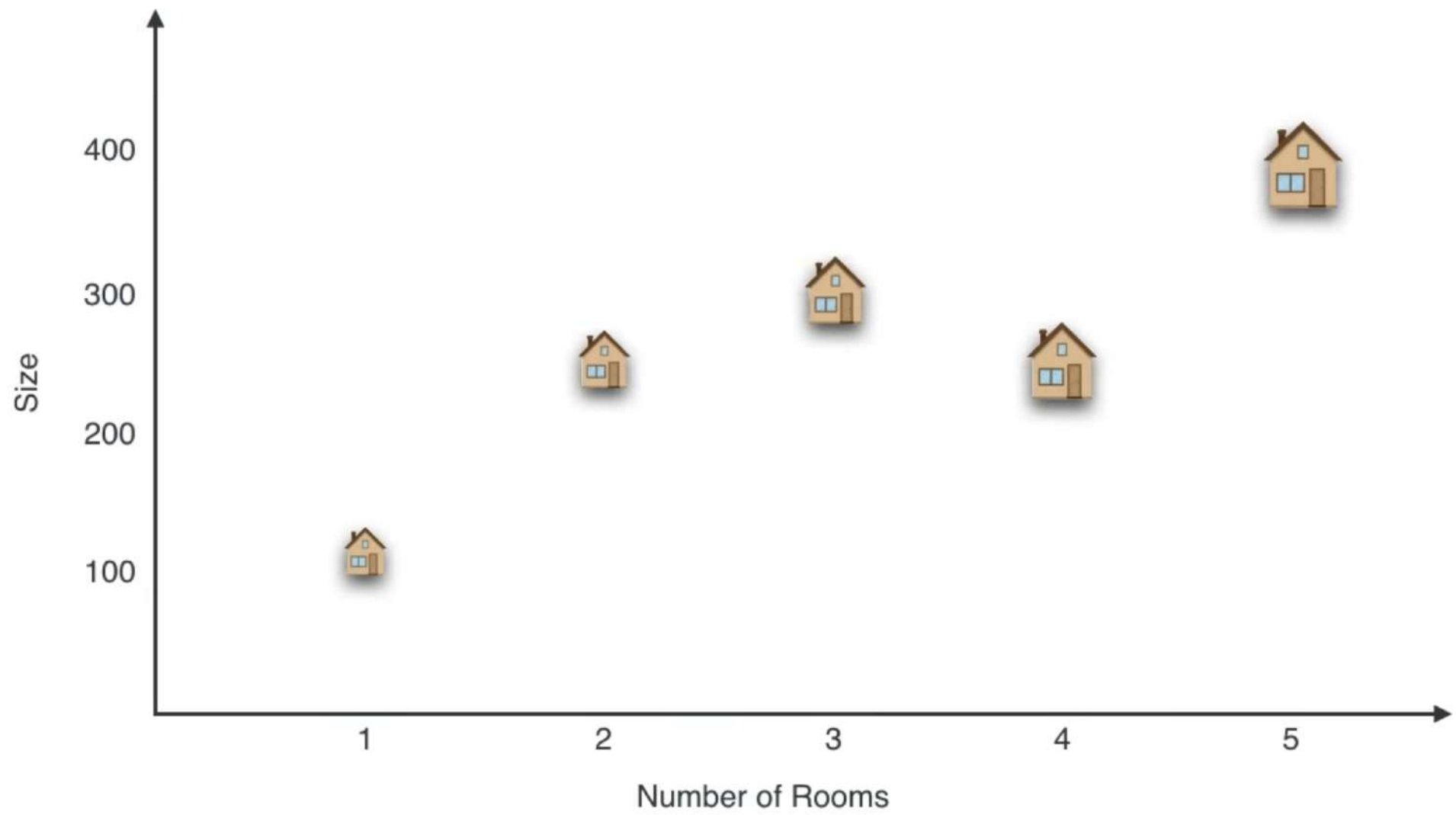
Schools around

Crime rate

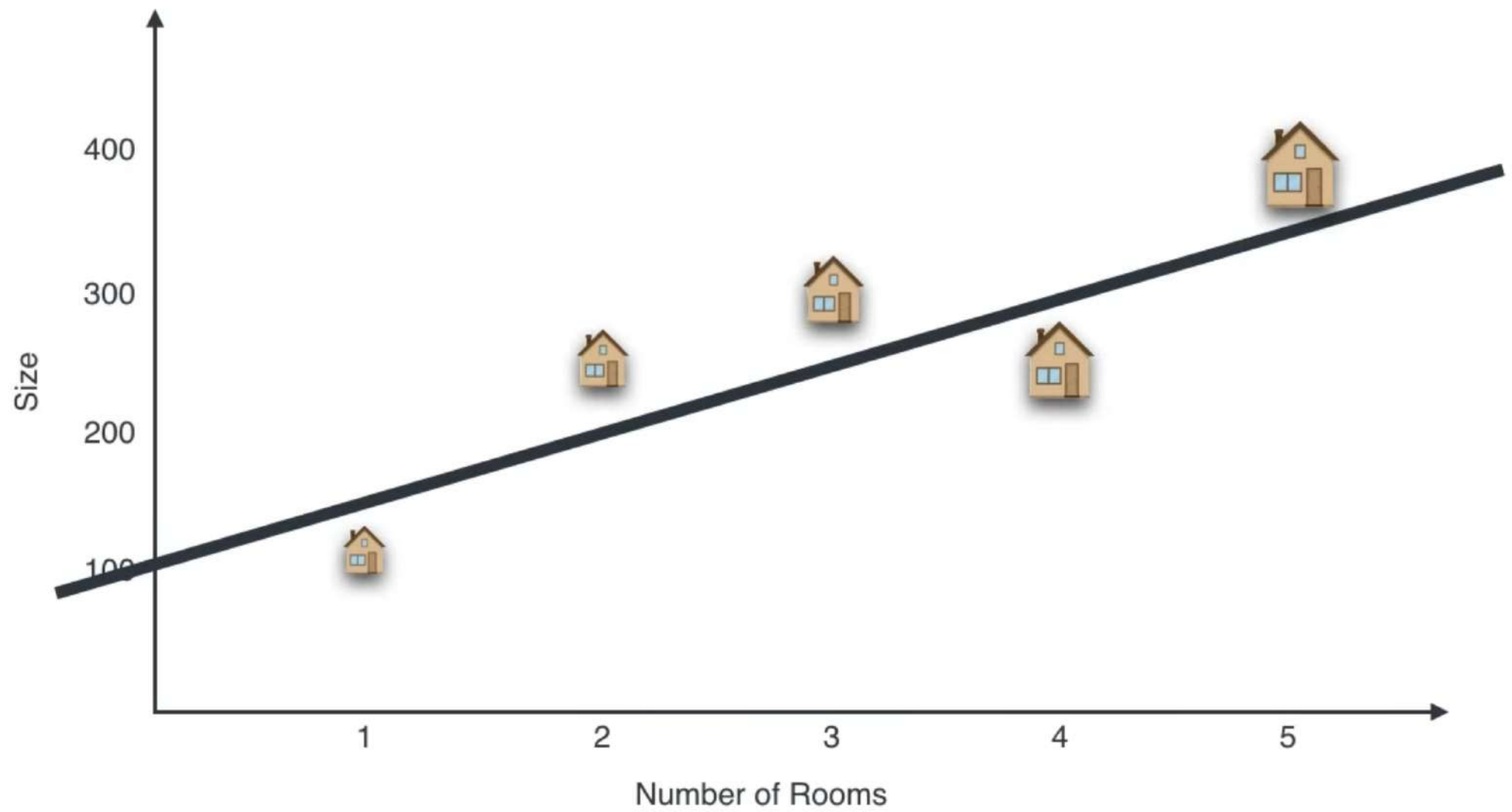


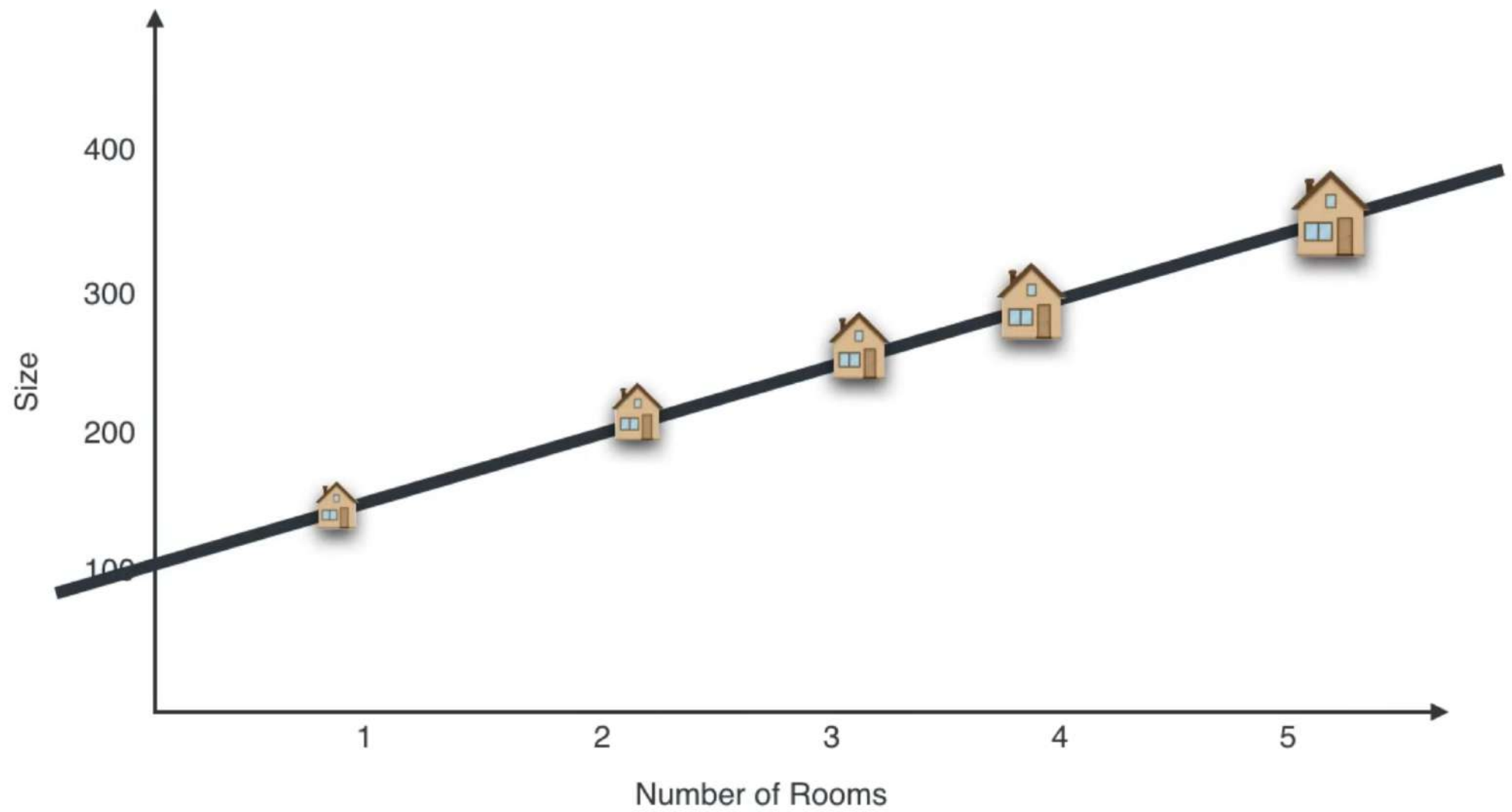
# Housing Data







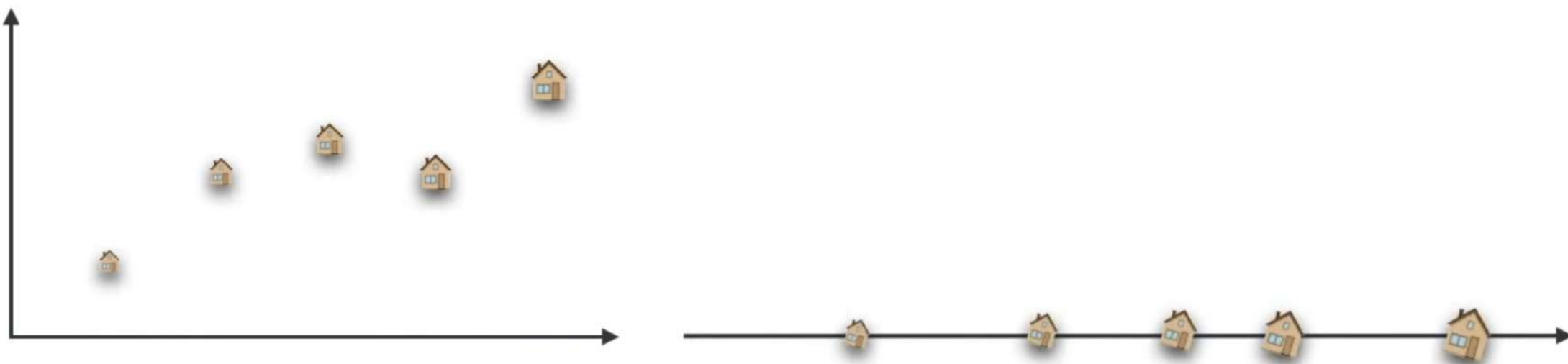






Size feature





2 dimensions

size  
number of rooms

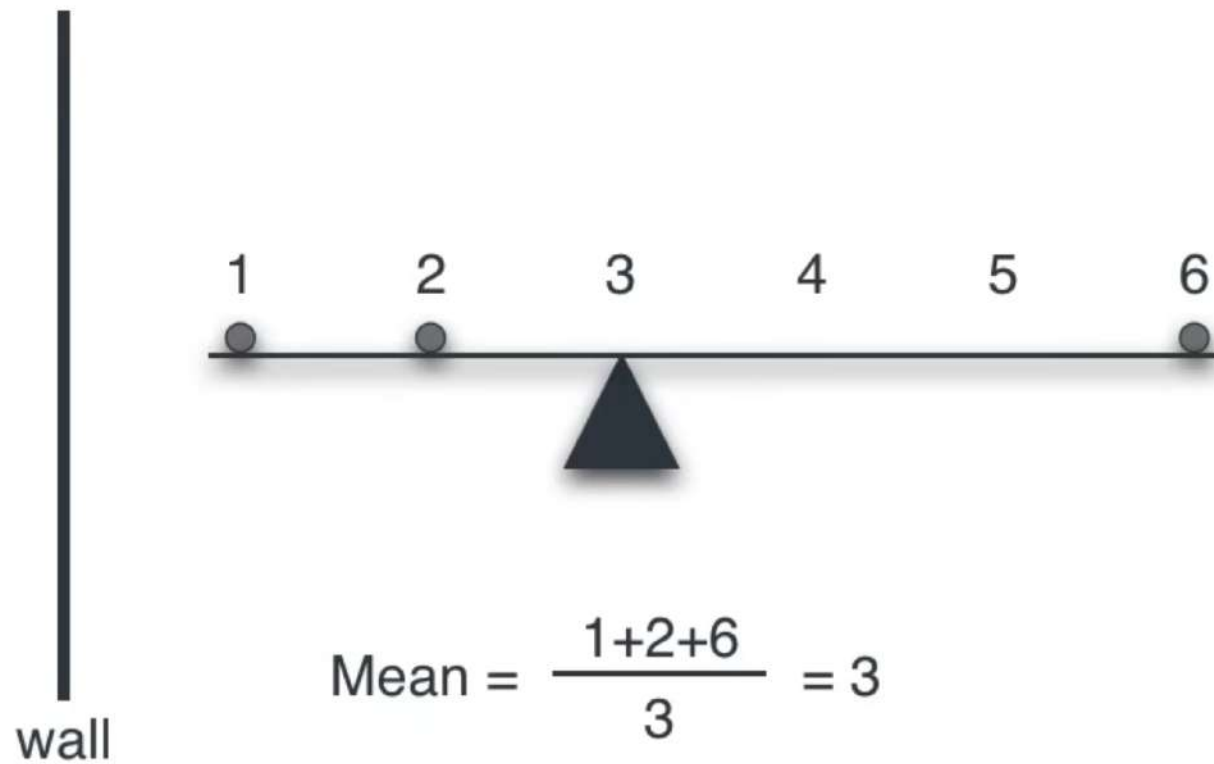


1 dimension

size feature



# Mean





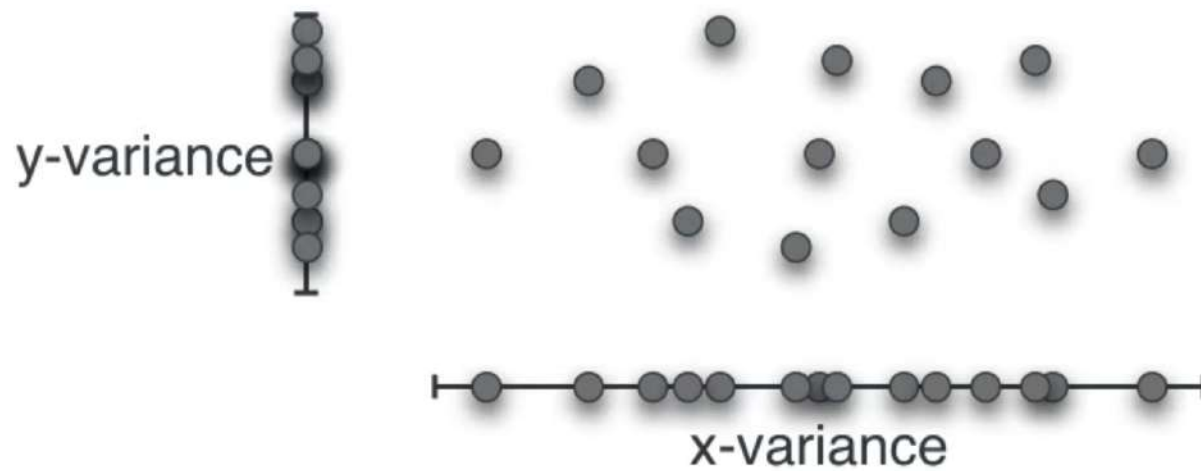
# Variance



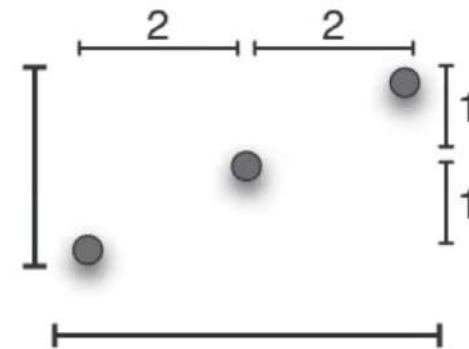
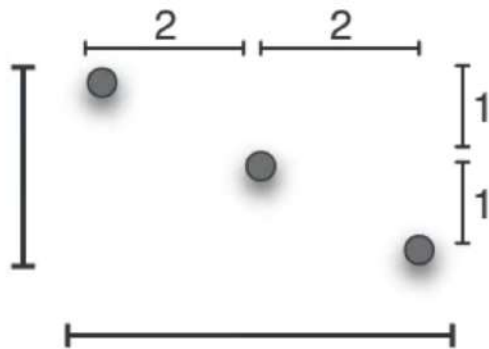
$$\text{Variance} = \frac{1^2 + 0^2 + 1^2}{3} = 2/3$$



# Variance?



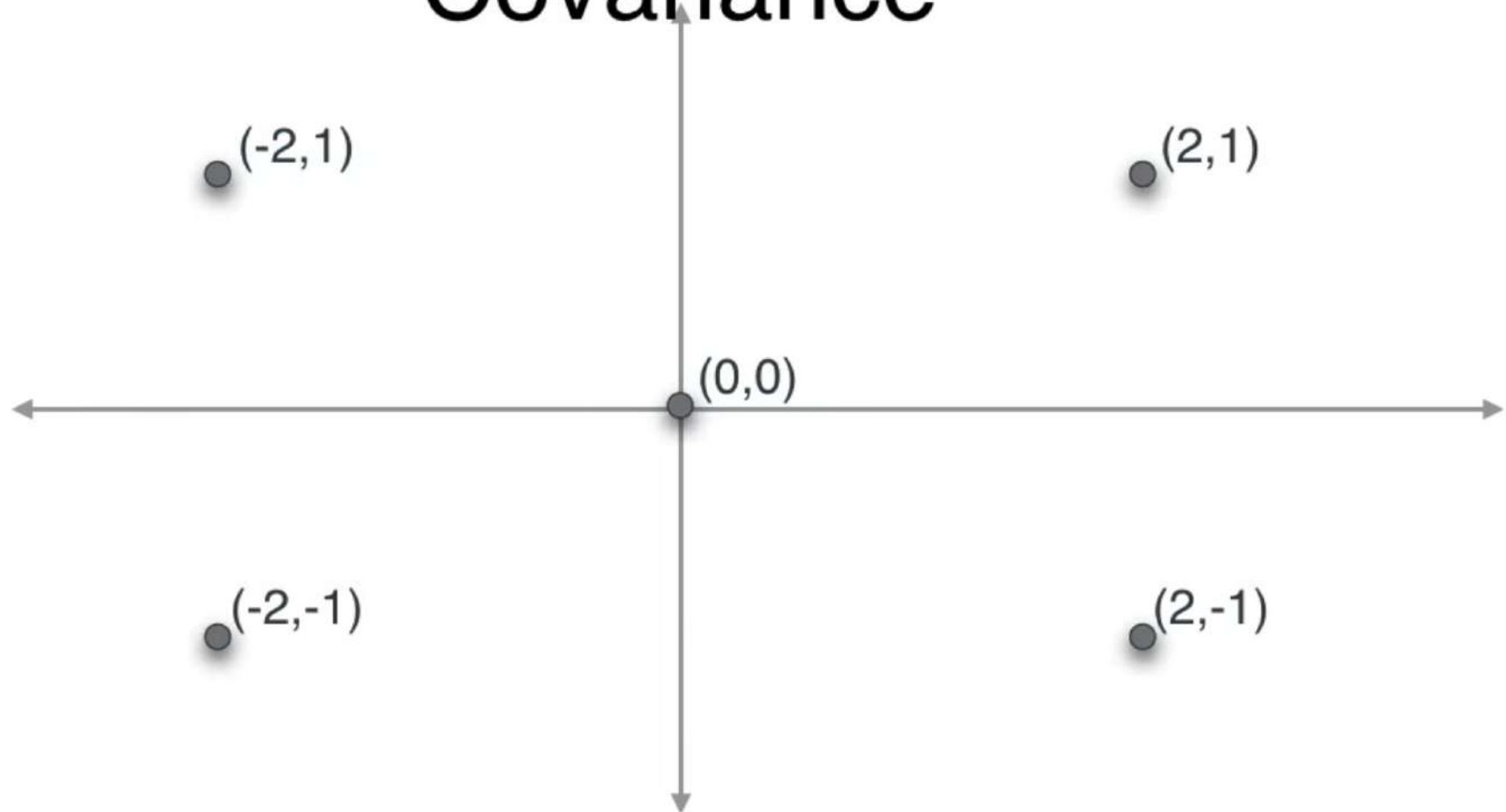
# Variance?



$$\text{x-variance} = \frac{2^2 + 0^2 + 2^2}{3} = 8/3$$

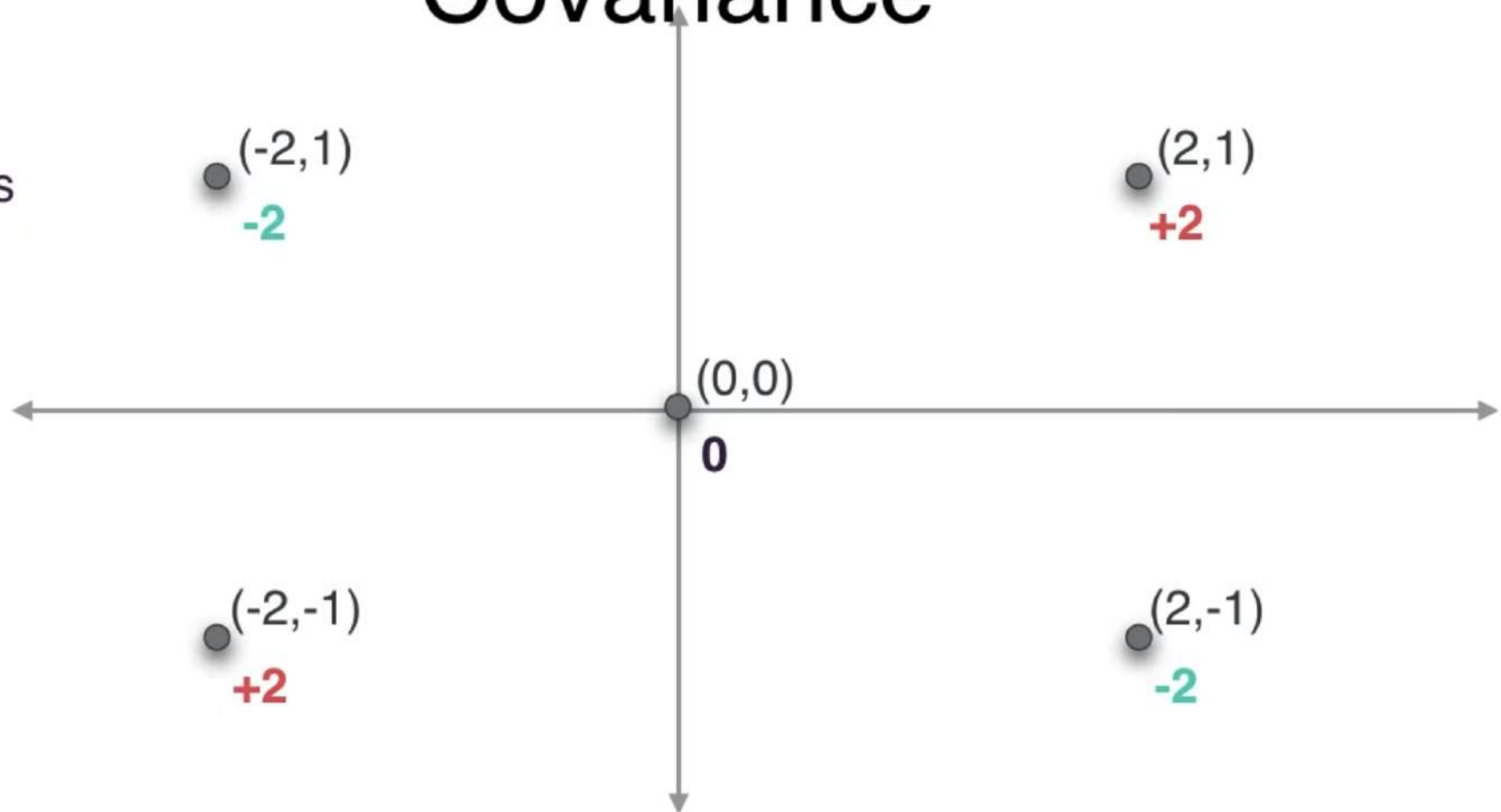
$$\text{y-variance} = \frac{1^2 + 0^2 + 1^2}{3} = 2/3$$

# Covariance

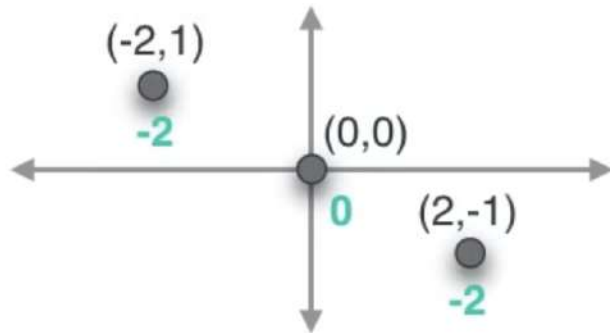


# Covariance

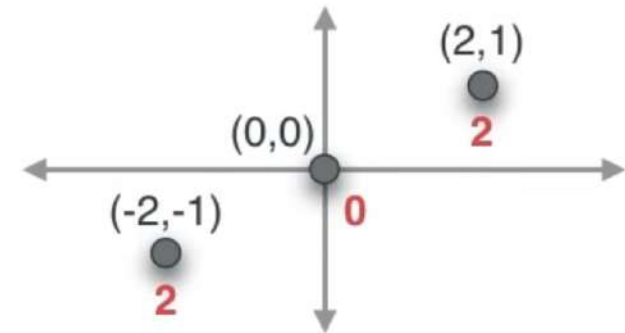
Product  
of  
coordinates



# Covariance



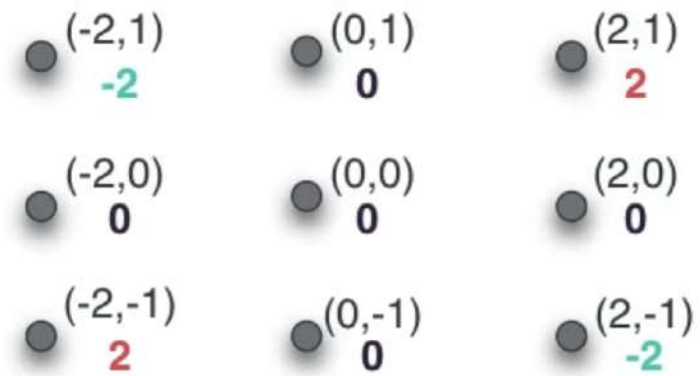
$$\text{covariance} = \frac{(-2) + 0 + (-2)}{3} = -4/3$$



$$\text{covariance} = \frac{2 + 0 + 2}{3} = 4/3$$

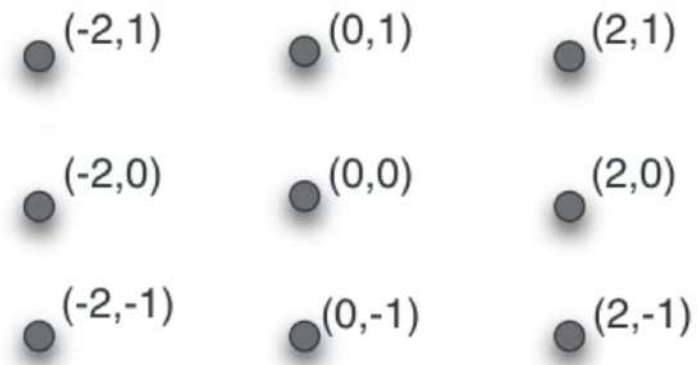


# Covariance



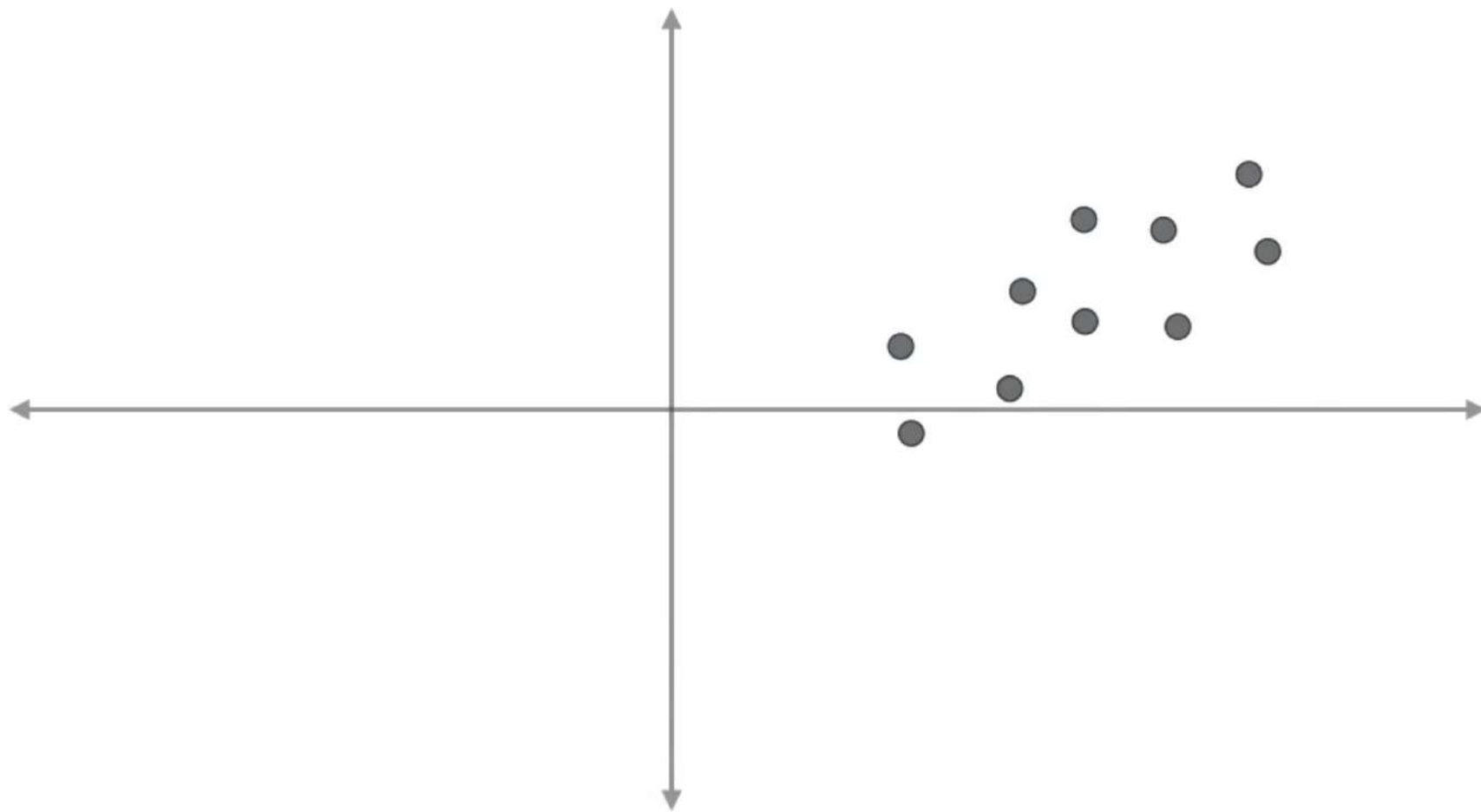


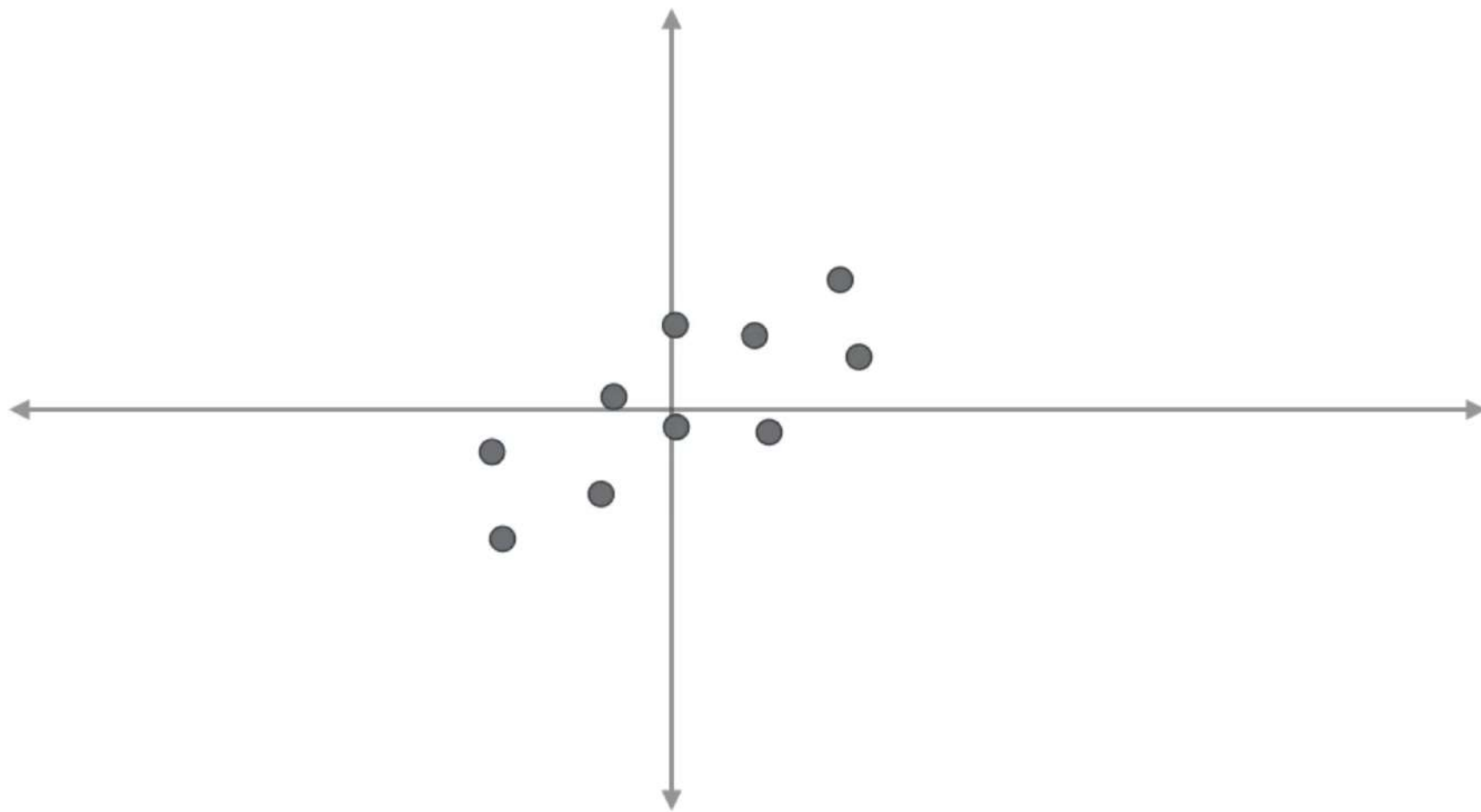
# Covariance



$$\text{covariance} = \frac{-2 + 0 + 2 + 0 + 0 + 0 + 0 + 2 + 0 + -2}{9} = 0$$

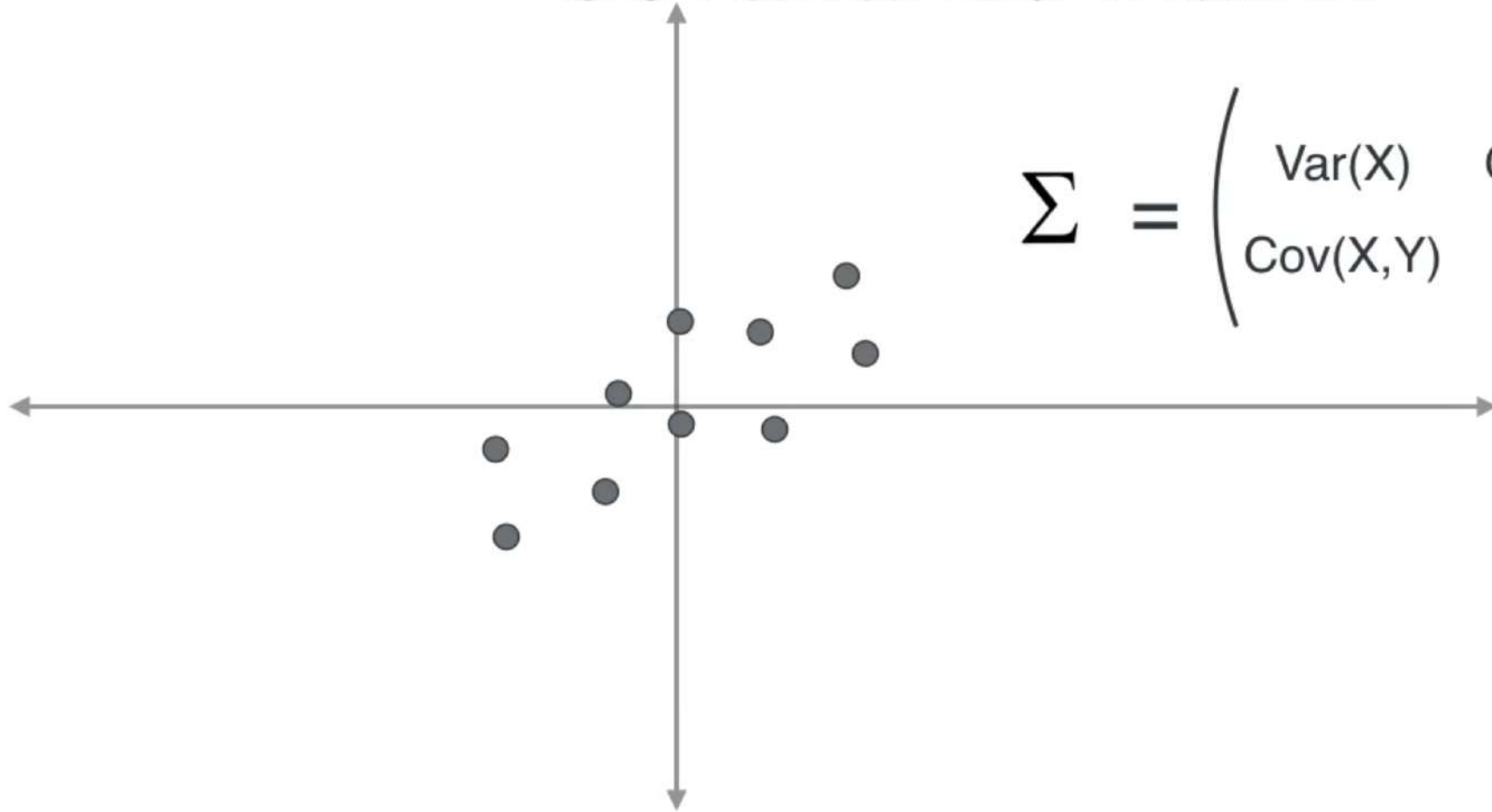






# Covariance matrix

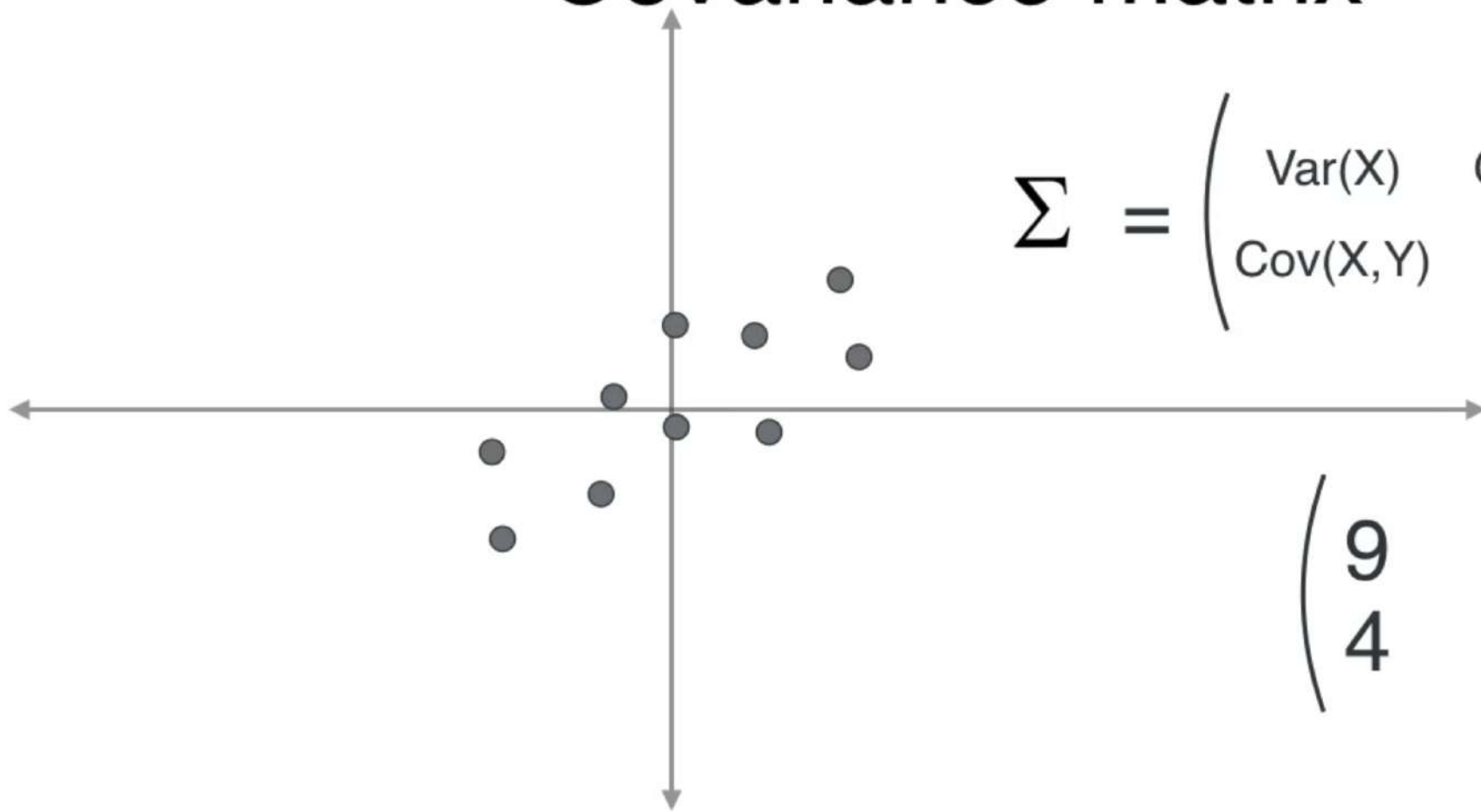
$$\Sigma = \begin{pmatrix} \text{Var}(X) & \text{Cov}(X, Y) \\ \text{Cov}(X, Y) & \text{Var}(Y) \end{pmatrix}$$



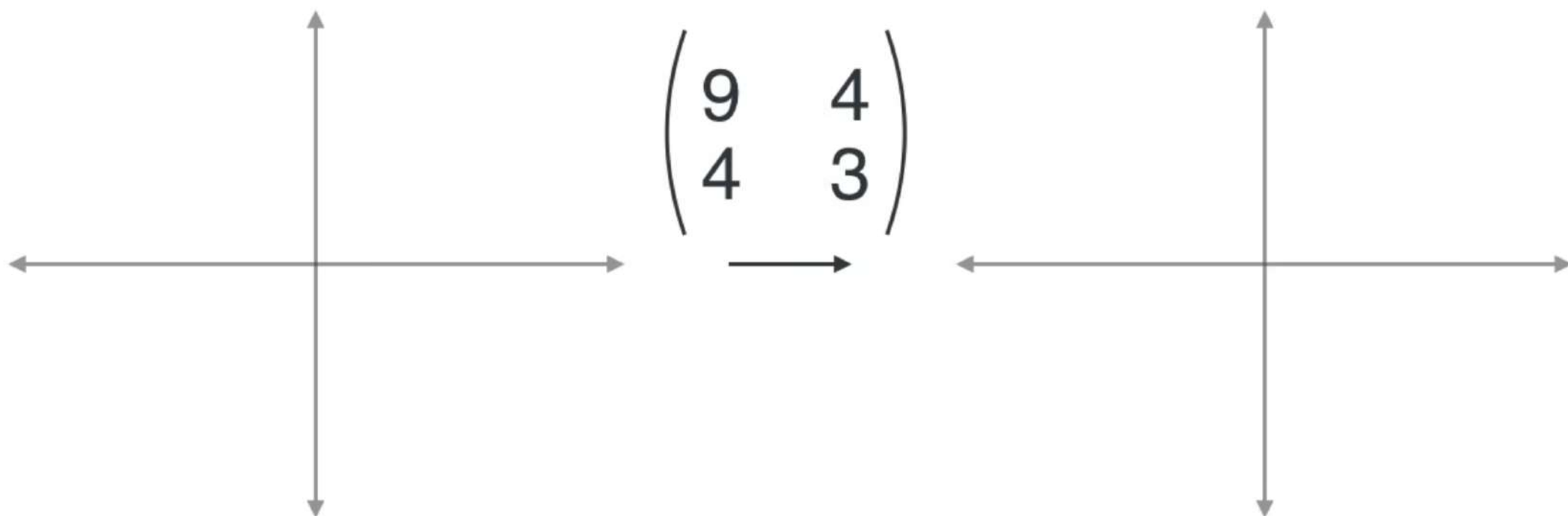
# Covariance matrix

$$\Sigma = \begin{pmatrix} \text{Var}(X) & \text{Cov}(X,Y) \\ \text{Cov}(X,Y) & \text{Var}(Y) \end{pmatrix}$$

$$\begin{pmatrix} 9 & 4 \\ 4 & 3 \end{pmatrix}$$



# Linear Transformations



# Linear Transformations

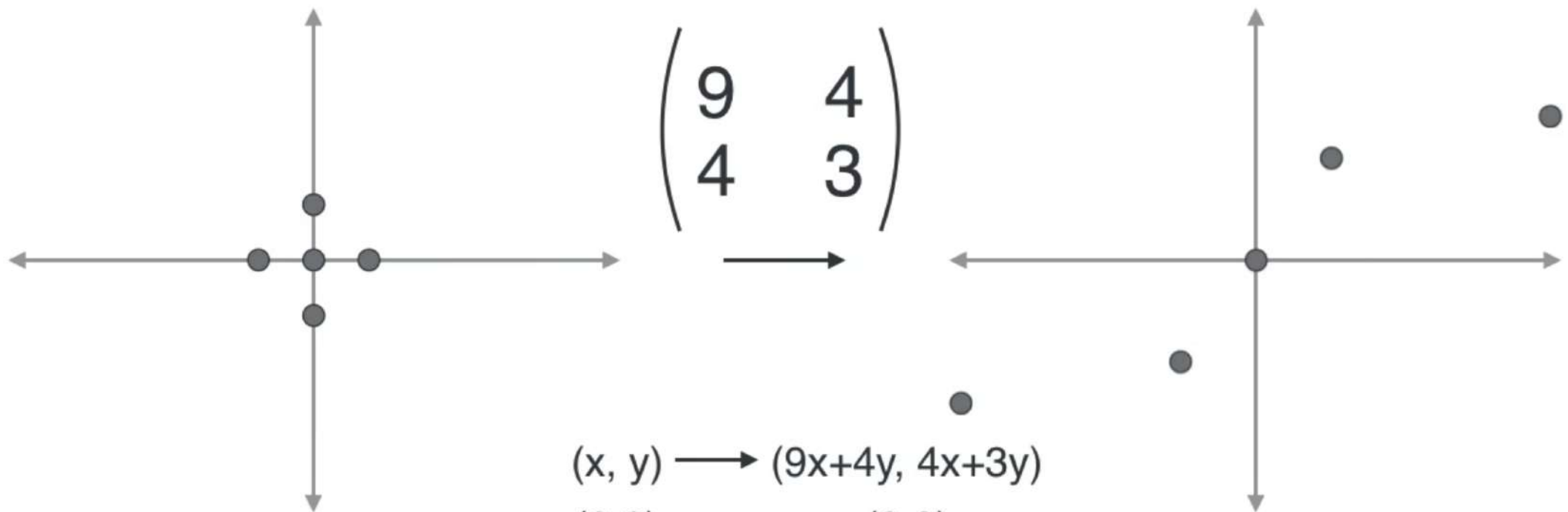
$$\begin{pmatrix} 9 & 4 \\ 4 & 3 \end{pmatrix}$$

$$(x, y) \longrightarrow (9x+4y, 4x+3y)$$





# Linear Transformations



$$\begin{pmatrix} 9 & 4 \\ 4 & 3 \end{pmatrix}$$

$$(x, y) \longrightarrow (9x+4y, 4x+3y)$$

$$(0,0) \quad (0,0)$$

$$(1,0) \quad (9,4)$$

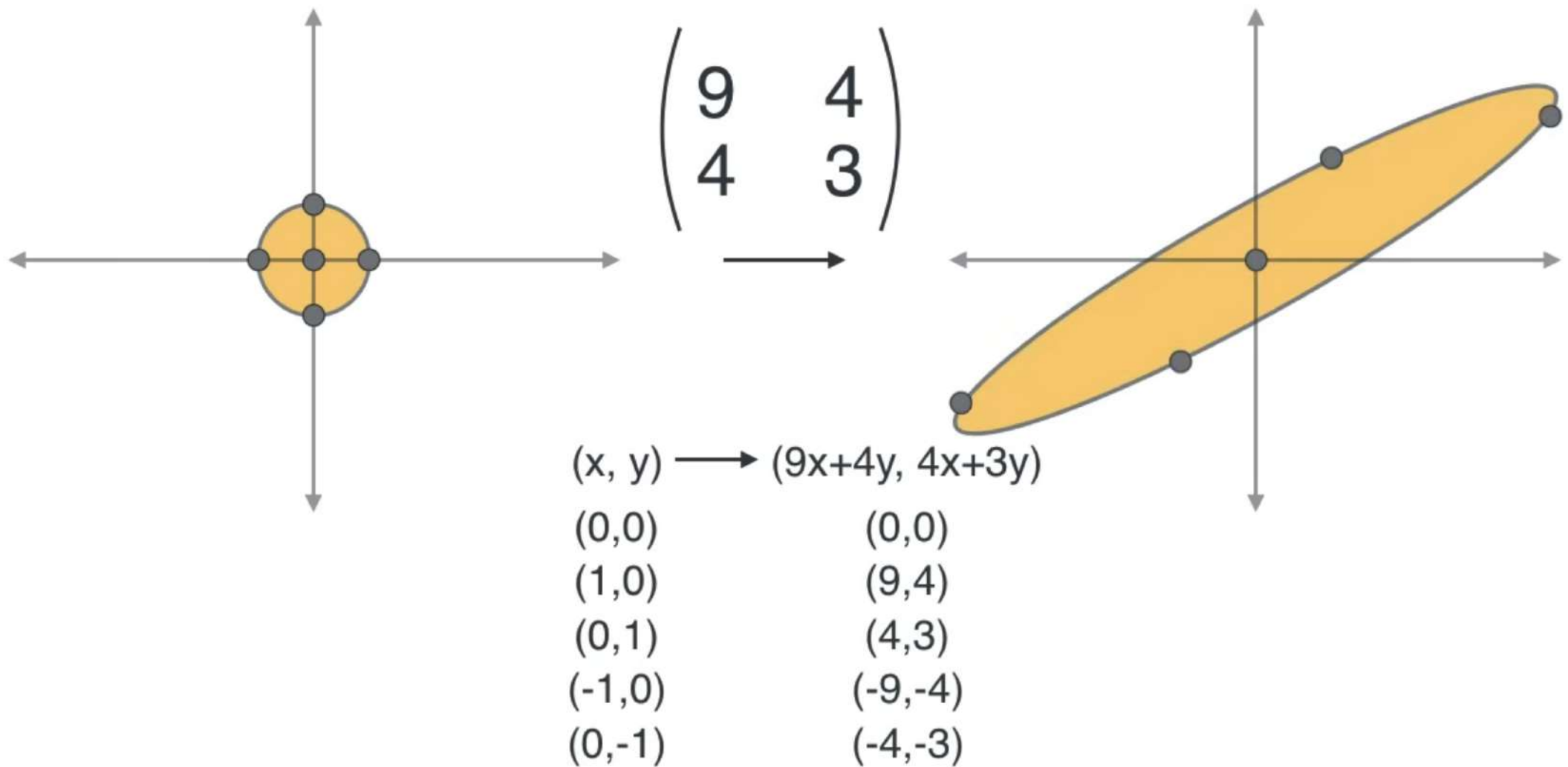
$$(0,1) \quad (4,3)$$

$$(-1,0) \quad (-9,-4)$$

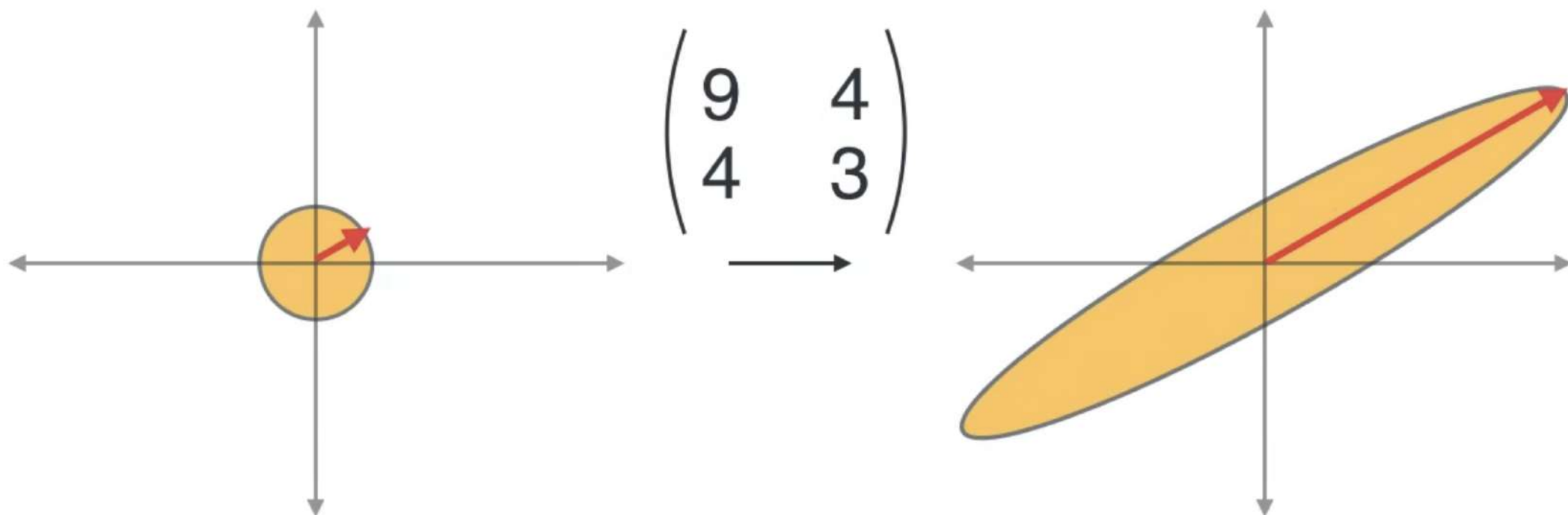
$$(0,-1) \quad (-4,-3)$$



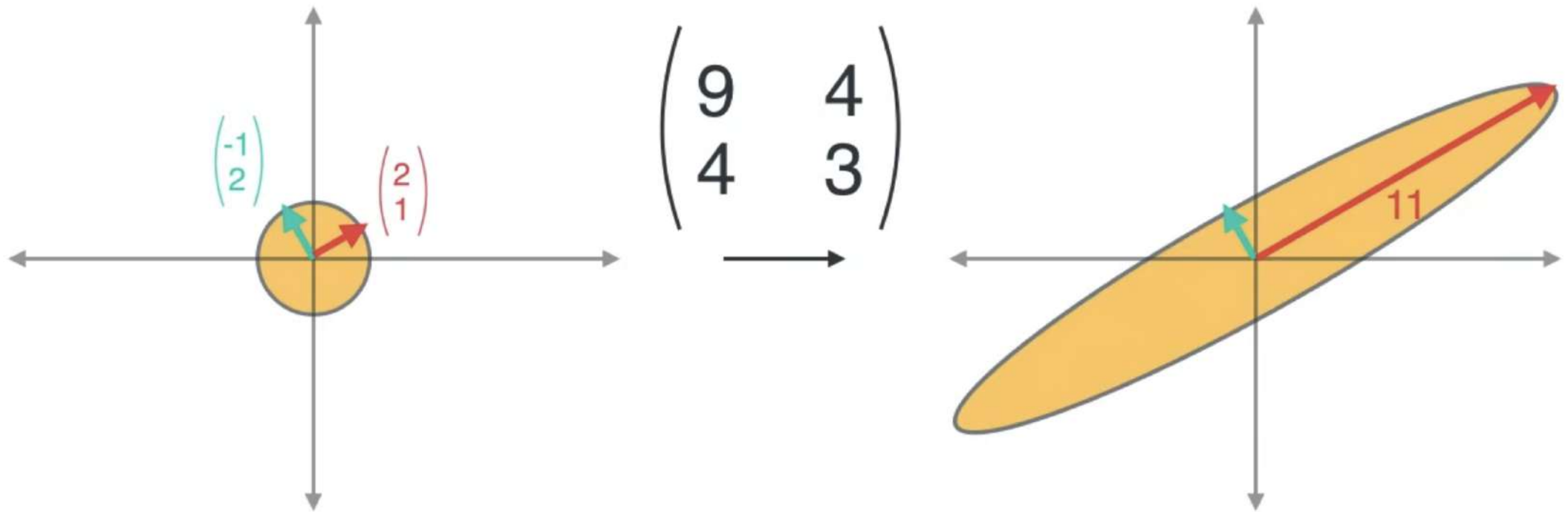
# Linear Transformations



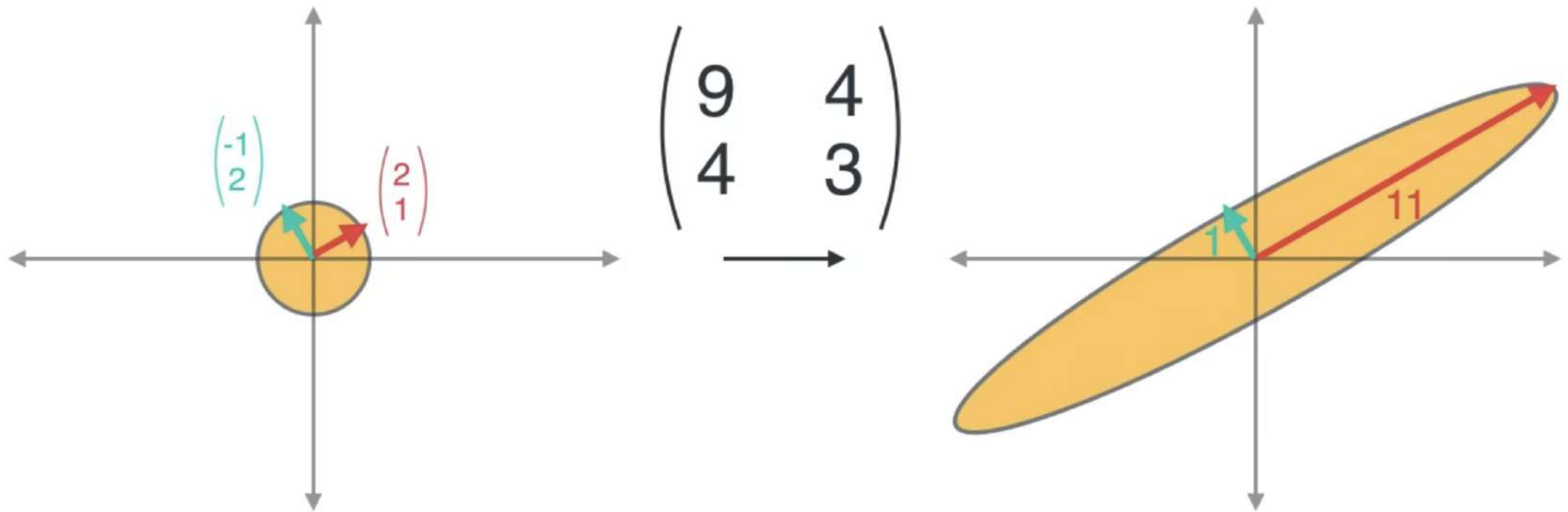
# Linear Transformations



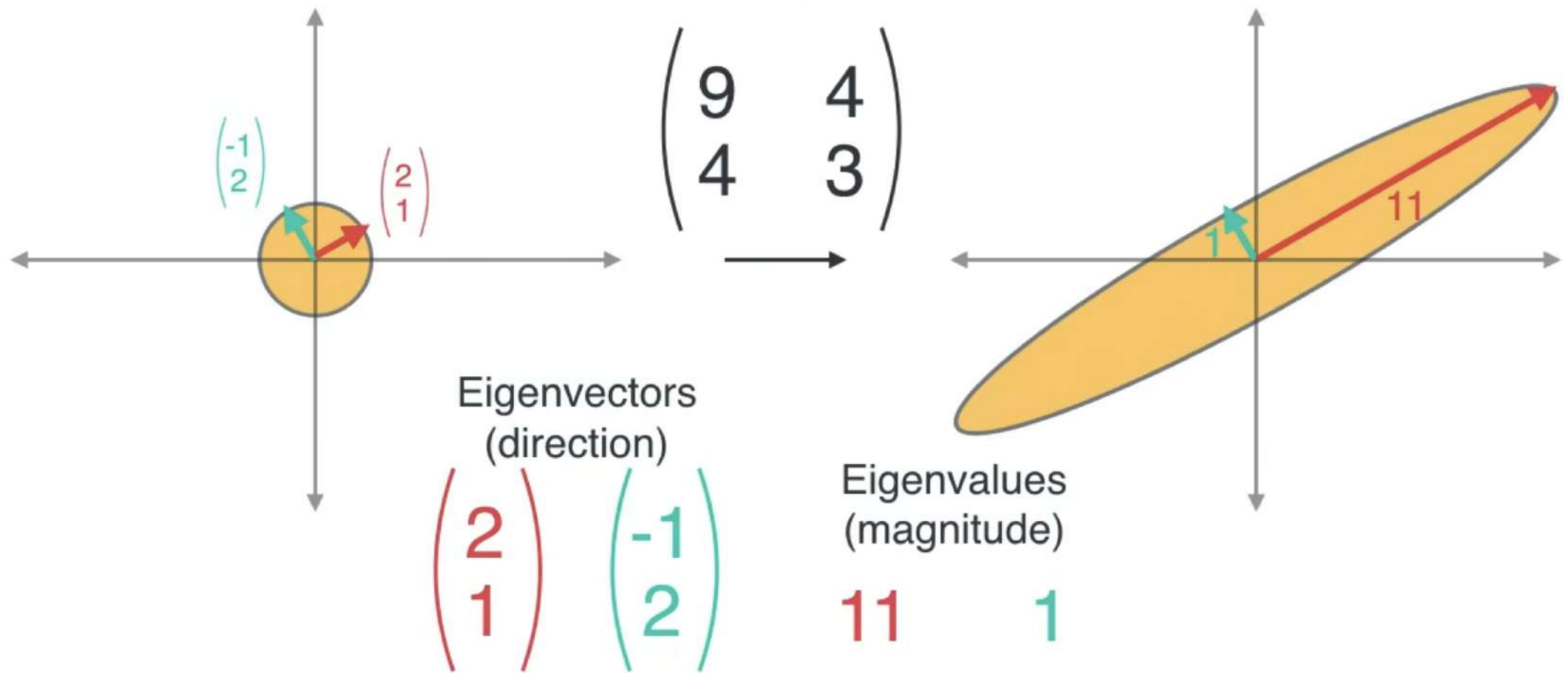
# Linear Transformations



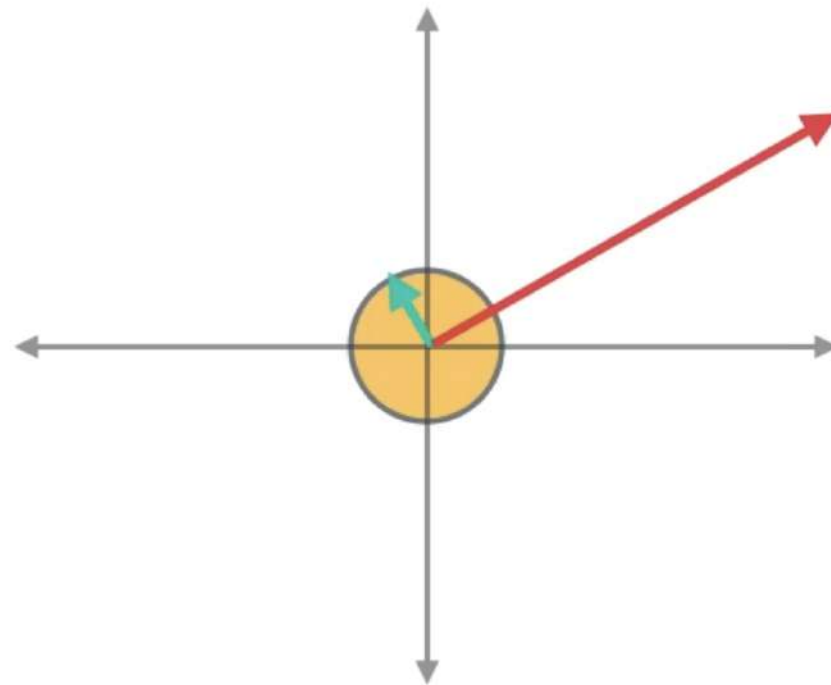
# Linear Transformations



# Linear Transformations



# Linear Transformations



Eigenvectors

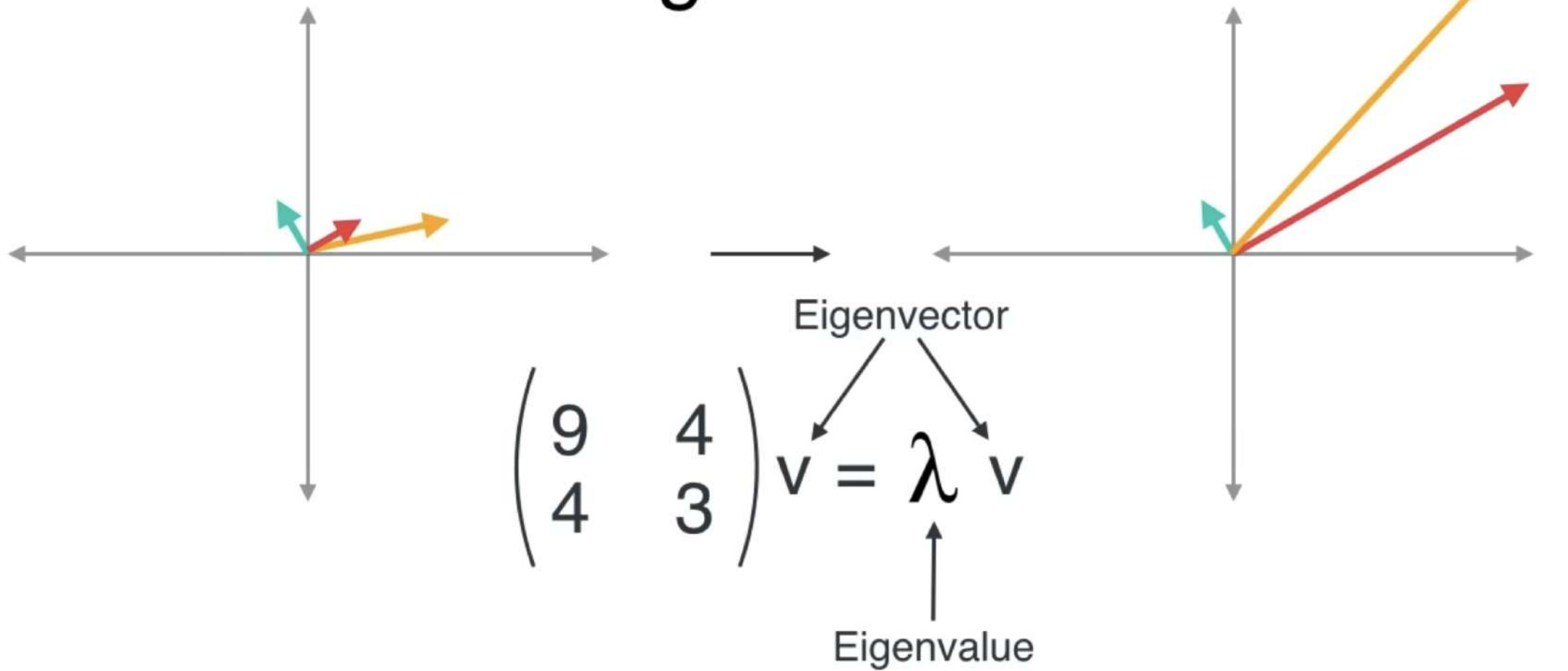
$$\begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} \quad \begin{pmatrix} -1 \\ 2 \end{pmatrix}$$

Eigenvalues

$$11 \quad 1$$



# Eigenstuff





# Eigenvalues

$$\begin{pmatrix} 9 & 4 \\ 4 & 3 \end{pmatrix}$$

Characteristic Polynomial

$$\begin{vmatrix} x-9 & -4 \\ -4 & x-3 \end{vmatrix} = (x-9)(x-3) - (-4)(-4) = x^2 - 12x + 11 \\ = (x-11)(x-1)$$

Eigenvalues **11** and **1**



# Eigenvectors

$$\begin{pmatrix} 9 & 4 \\ 4 & 3 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} u \\ v \end{pmatrix} = 11 \begin{pmatrix} u \\ v \end{pmatrix}$$

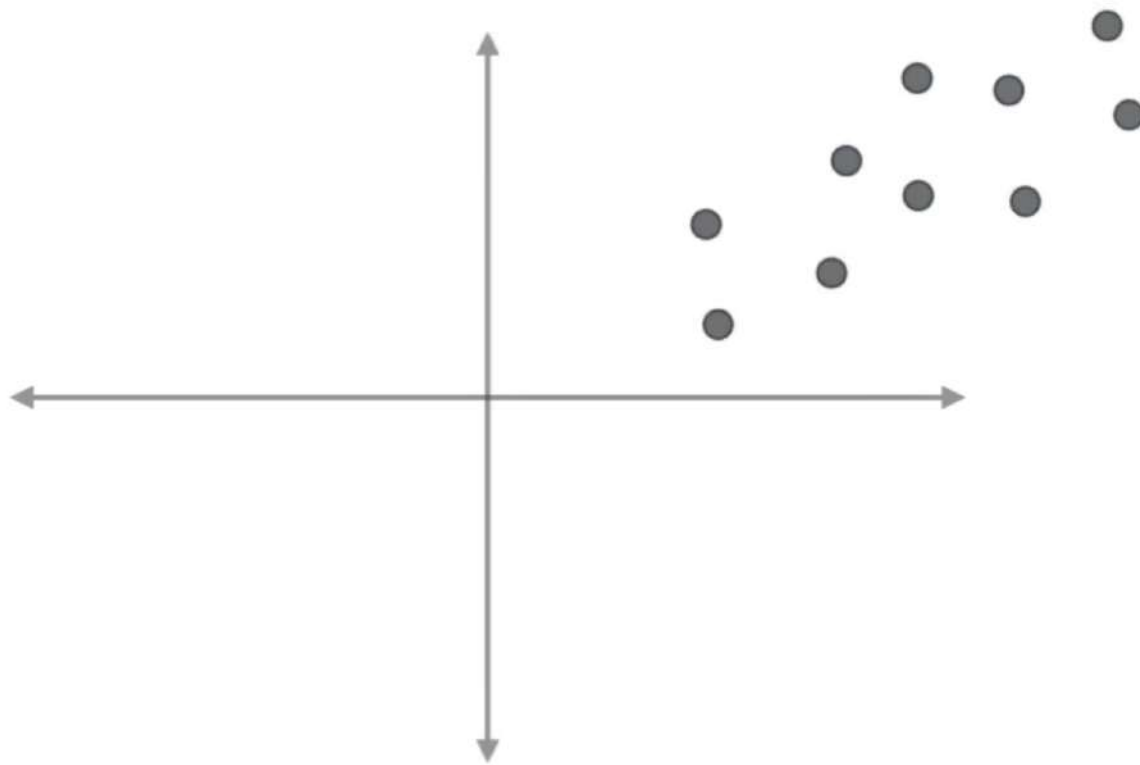
$$\begin{pmatrix} u \\ v \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}$$

$$\begin{pmatrix} 9 & 4 \\ 4 & 3 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} u \\ v \end{pmatrix} = 1 \begin{pmatrix} u \\ v \end{pmatrix}$$

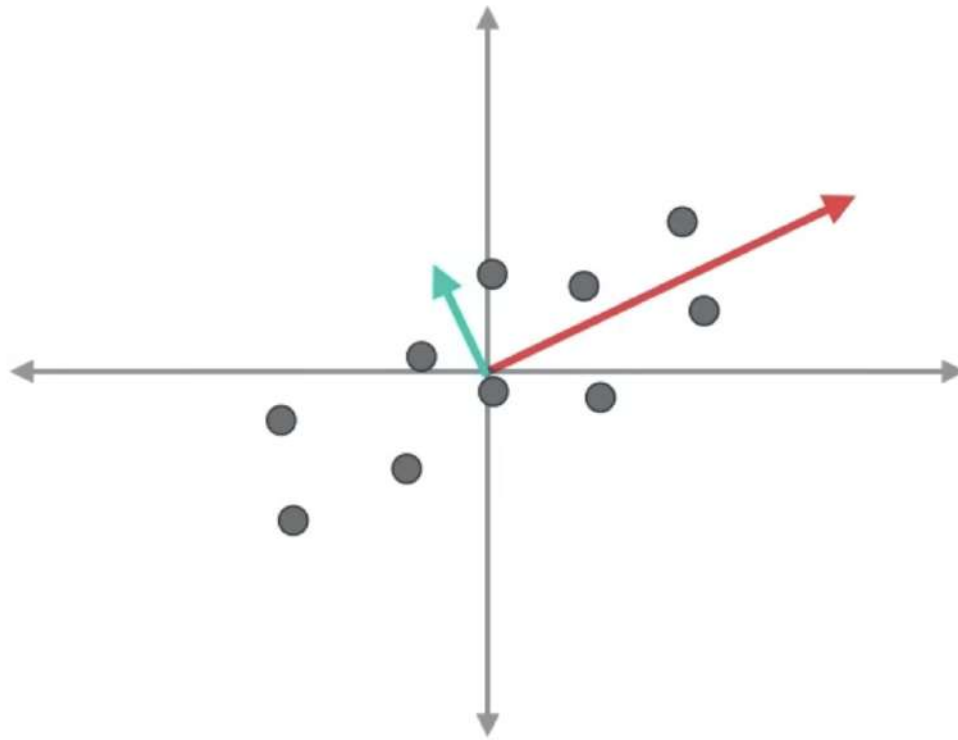
$$\begin{pmatrix} u \\ v \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} -1 \\ 2 \end{pmatrix}$$



# Principal Component Analysis (PCA)



# Principal Component Analysis (PCA)



$$\Sigma = \begin{pmatrix} 9 & 4 \\ 4 & 3 \end{pmatrix}$$

$$\begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}$$

$$\begin{pmatrix} -1 \\ 2 \end{pmatrix}$$

Eigenvectors  
(direction)

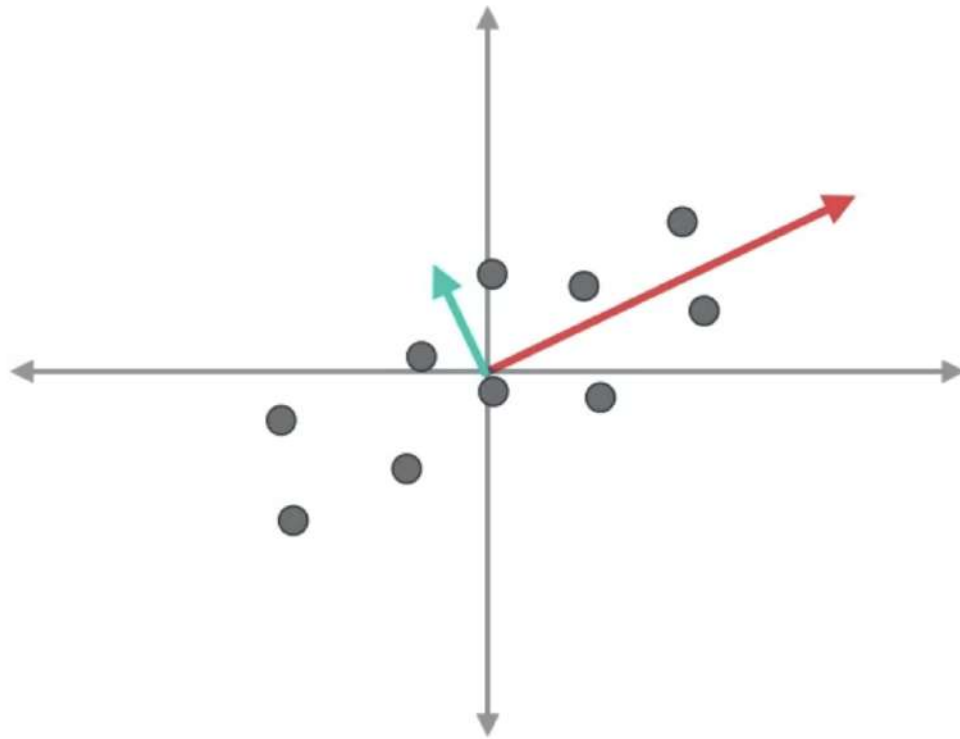
$$11$$

$$1$$

Eigenvalues  
(magnitude)



# Principal Component Analysis (PCA)



$$\Sigma = \begin{pmatrix} 9 & 4 \\ 4 & 3 \end{pmatrix}$$

$$\begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}$$

$$\begin{pmatrix} -1 \\ 2 \end{pmatrix}$$

Eigenvectors  
(direction)

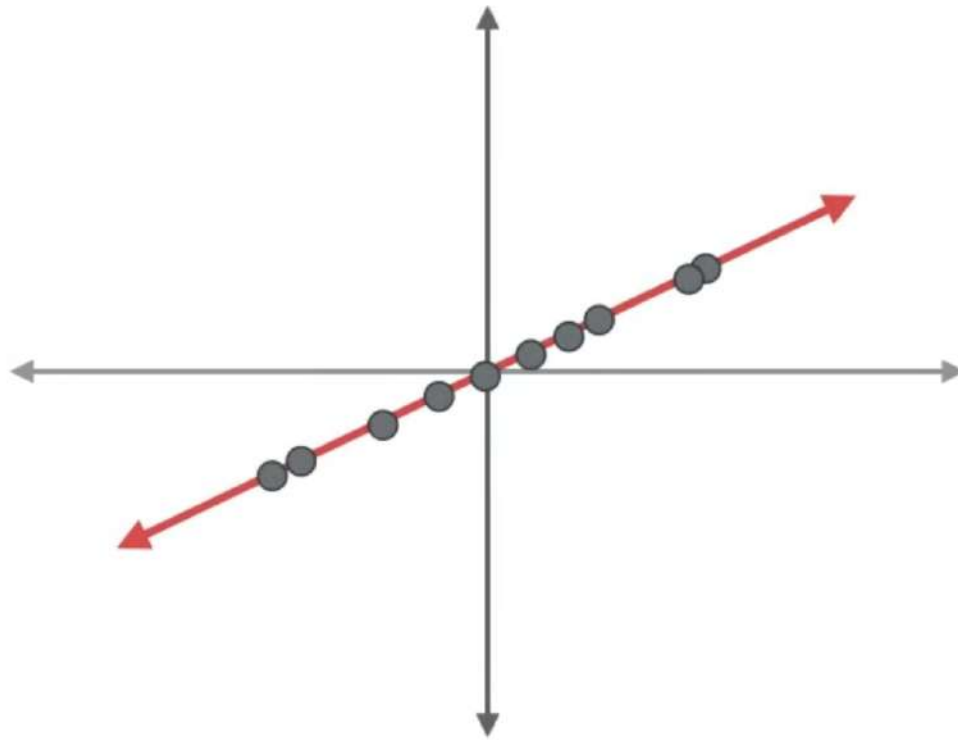
$$11$$

$$1$$

Eigenvalues  
(magnitude)



# Principal Component Analysis (PCA)



$$\Sigma = \begin{pmatrix} 9 & 4 \\ 4 & 3 \end{pmatrix}$$

$$\begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}$$

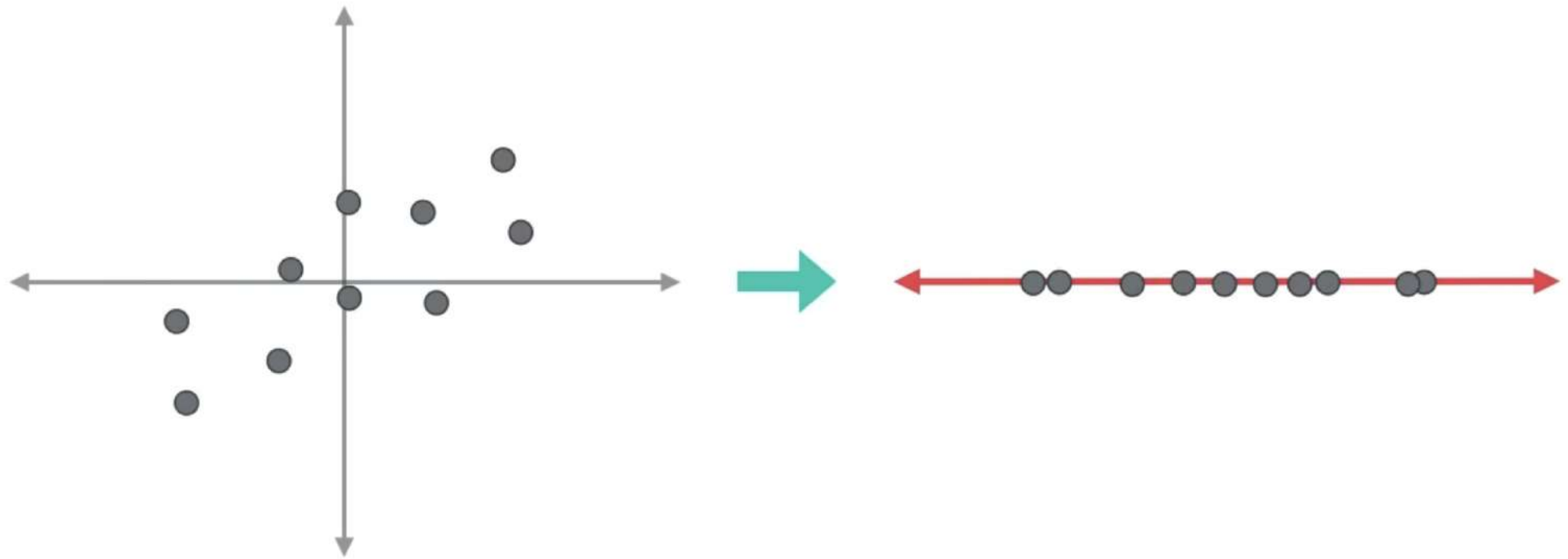
Eigenvectors  
(direction)

$$11$$

Eigenvalues  
(magnitude)



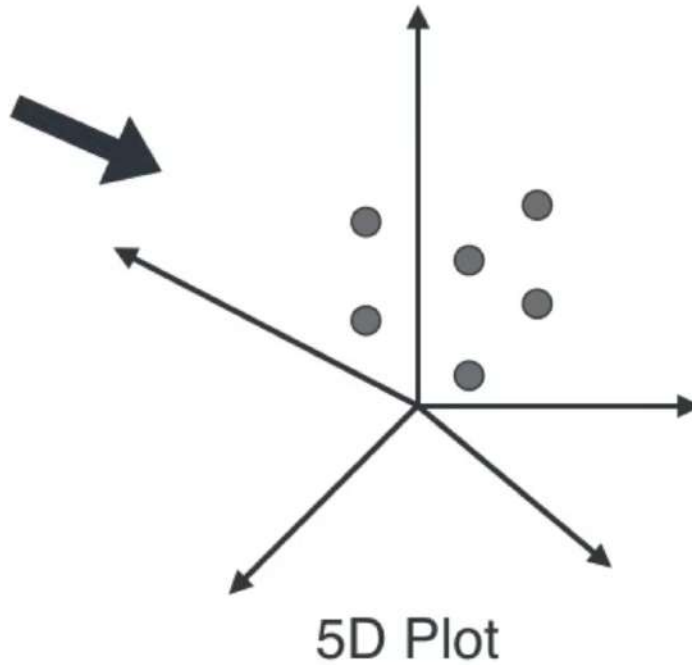
# Principal Component Analysis (PCA)



# PCA

Large Table

| X1 | X2 | X3 | X4 | X5 |
|----|----|----|----|----|
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |





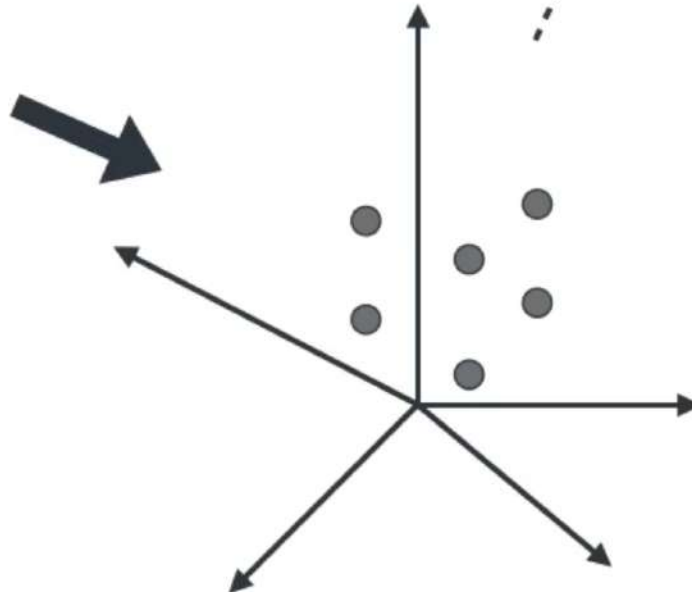
# PCA

Large Table

| X1 | X2 | X3 | X4 | X5 |
|----|----|----|----|----|
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |

Covariance matrix

$$\begin{pmatrix} * & * & * & * & * \\ * & * & * & * & * \\ * & * & * & * & * \\ * & * & * & * & * \\ * & * & * & * & * \end{pmatrix}$$



5D Plot

# PCA

Large Table

| X1 | X2 | X3 | X4 | X5 |
|----|----|----|----|----|
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
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| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |

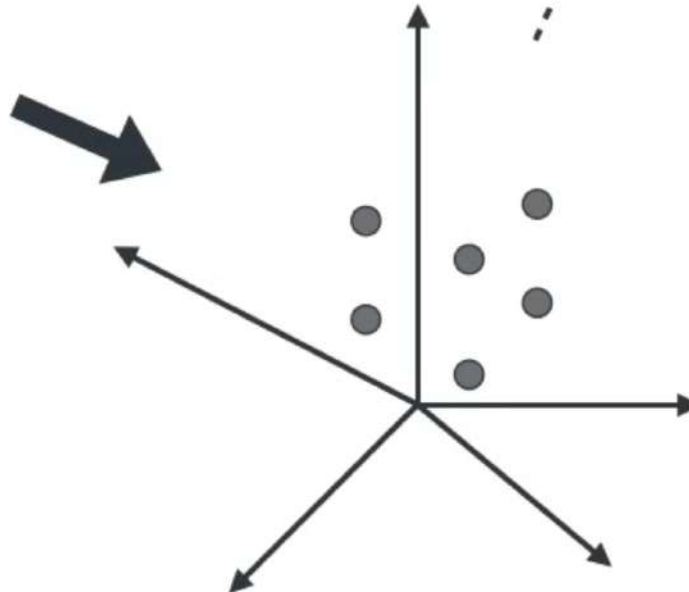
Covariance matrix

|   |   |   |   |   |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| * | * | * | * | * |
| * | * | * | * | * |
| * | * | * | * | * |
| * | * | * | * | * |
| * | * | * | * | * |

Eigenstuff

$V_1$   $\lambda_1$   
 $V_2$   $\lambda_2$   
 $V_3$   $\lambda_3$   
 $V_4$   $\lambda_4$   
 $V_5$   $\lambda_5$

Big  
Small



5D Plot



# PCA

Large Table

| X1 | X2 | X3 | X4 | X5 |
|----|----|----|----|----|
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |

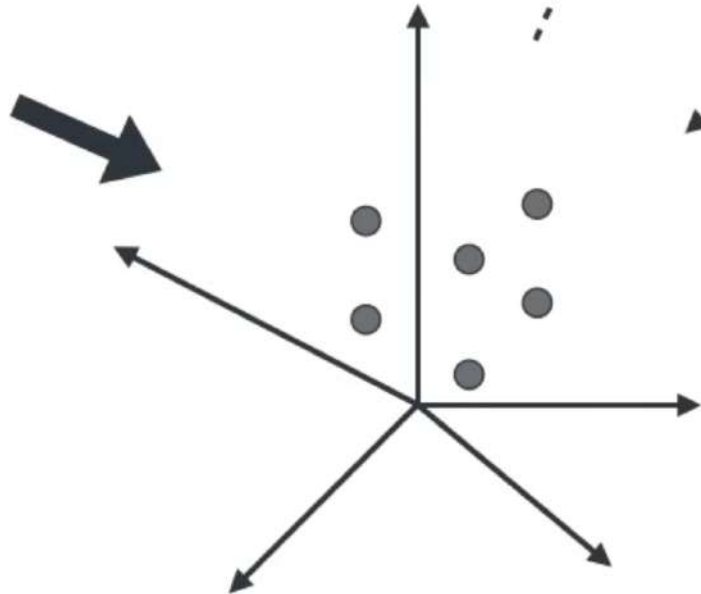
Covariance matrix

$$\begin{pmatrix} * & * & * & * & * \\ * & * & * & * & * \\ * & * & * & * & * \\ * & * & * & * & * \\ * & * & * & * & * \end{pmatrix}$$

Eigenstuff

$V_1$   $\lambda_1$   
 $V_2$   $\lambda_2$

Big  
Small



5D Plot



# PCA

Large Table

| X1 | X2 | X3 | X4 | X5 |
|----|----|----|----|----|
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |

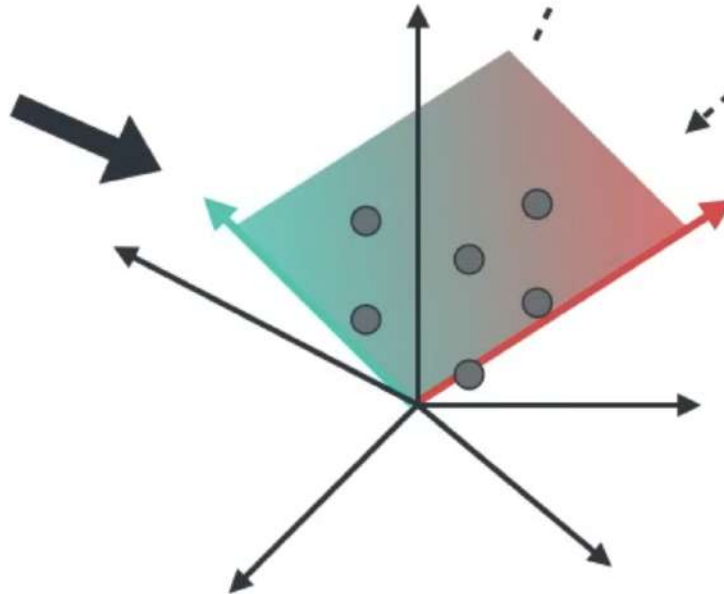
Covariance matrix

$$\begin{pmatrix} * & * & * & * & * \\ * & * & * & * & * \\ * & * & * & * & * \\ * & * & * & * & * \\ * & * & * & * & * \end{pmatrix}$$

Eigenstuff

$V_1$   $\lambda_1$   
 $V_2$   $\lambda_2$

Big  
Small



5D Plot



# PCA

Large Table

| X1 | X2 | X3 | X4 | X5 |
|----|----|----|----|----|
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |

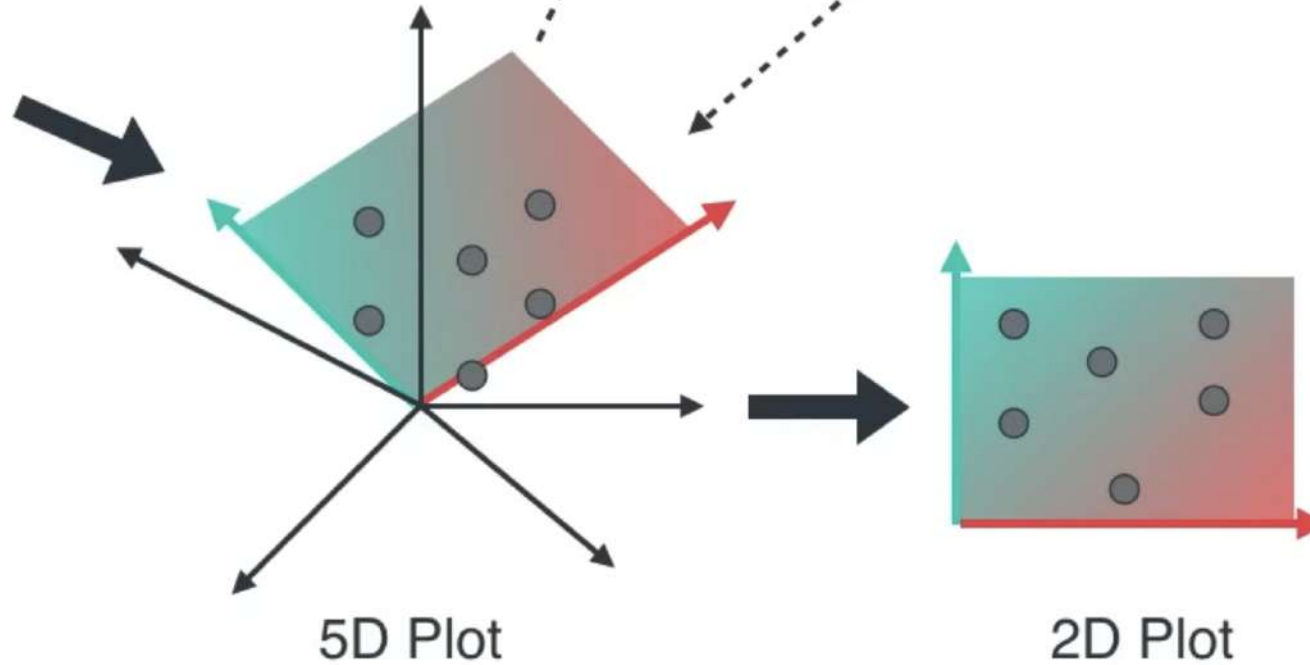
Covariance matrix

$$\begin{pmatrix} * & * & * & * & * \\ * & * & * & * & * \\ * & * & * & * & * \\ * & * & * & * & * \\ * & * & * & * & * \end{pmatrix}$$

Eigenstuff

$V_1$   $\lambda_1$   
 $V_2$   $\lambda_2$

Big  
Small



# PCA

Large Table

| X1 | X2 | X3 | X4 | X5 |
|----|----|----|----|----|
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |
| *  | *  | *  | *  | *  |

Covariance matrix

$$\begin{pmatrix} * & * & * & * & * \\ * & * & * & * & * \\ * & * & * & * & * \\ * & * & * & * & * \\ * & * & * & * & * \end{pmatrix}$$

Eigenstuff

$V_1$   $\lambda_1$   
 $V_2$   $\lambda_2$

Big  
Small

Small Table

| W1 | W2 |
|----|----|
| *  | *  |
| *  | *  |
| *  | *  |
| *  | *  |
| *  | *  |
| *  | *  |
| *  | *  |
| *  | *  |
| *  | *  |
| *  | *  |
| *  | *  |
| *  | *  |
| *  | *  |

